



The Lunar Way

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E PLVRIBVS VNVM. We Are All One (1)

A Gloranthan solo exploration story first using HQ/G rules, then gradually incorporating tests of other rules that ultimately led to **Glorantha Perspectives**.

Download the consolidated PDF: [la-voie-lunaire.pdf](#)

The heroes (2)



Figure 1. The heroes

From left to right: - Jaridan, pacifist Tarshite merchant - Ikarnos of Raibanth, Imperial Shadow - Hanya, guardian of Jillaro, invested mercenary - Peek-ee-peek, chieftain's daughter, proud Sable nomad

The others

They are gathered in a glossary in alphabetical order.

Notes:

(1) My initial project was to explore the lunar vision of the world a bit further, but the heroes' incursion into Sartar ended up changing their outlook. And as the story progressed, I have the feeling they may end up straying completely from the Lunar Way, at least some of them. It goes to show that characters eventually escape their creator.

(2) The heroes were built in the HeroQuest/Glorantha fashion and reworked with **Rune Hearts** style: runes, culture, occupation, beliefs, relationships... All keywords that could serve as bets (on top of the bets obtained according to the situation)

The heroes

Hanya of Jillaro

“We must help the Goddess and preserve civilization”



Figure 2. Hanya

- Woman, 27 years old
- **Standard of living:** average
- **Equipment:** double-edged axe, bow, mercury armor (doesn't sink), horse (thoroughbred)

Runes



- Disciplined
- Intransigent
- Haughty toward barbarians



- Calm tensions
- Self-sacrifice
- Ride a horse



- Fast
- Cleaving axe blow
- Committed (the Empire is in danger!)

Lunar (Sylila)

Celestial Pantheon

- Knowledge of the Empire's laws
- Knowledge of the laws of the City of Jillaro
- Lunar citizen
- **Virtues:** opposes the Storm Pantheon, never harm the Goddess, the Emperor and the Empire, We are one, Tithe reversal, Can only be judged by an imperial tribunal.

Guardian of Jillaro

- Great axe combat (double-edged)
- Forced march
- Don't sleep
- Tactics
- Archery
- Horsemanship
- Aesthete

- War paint
- Shaved head (moon fashion)
- **Virtues:** honor, sacrifice, unwavering faith, beauty, Sylila first
- **Relations:**
 - the Fort of the Conquering Sister
 - some Silver Shields (regiment)

Novice of Hwarin Dalthippa

(Magic subject to the lunar cycle)

What Hanya learned from the goddess:

- Safe route
- See the long-term
- Intimidate barbarians
- Feel the enemy's weakness
- Cleaving axe blow
- Red Mask of Terror

Hanya is a somewhat unusual guardian because she doesn't have the moon rune. However, it doesn't matter, she is totally committed. For her, the Red Moon is more an object of fear and coercion to impose civilization. She has not been initiated into the inclusive mysteries.

Not gifted for construction like some of her sisters, she grasped its essence through her ability to "see the long term," as if she could feel the plans unfolding.

The teachings of Hwarin Dalthippa are indeed the following:

Construction

- Bless a construction
- Bless a tool
- Beautify a work
- Beautify a garden
- Strengthen a wall
- Steady hand
- Impassable door

Conquest

- Intimidation of barbarians
- Red Mask of Terror
- Feel the enemy's weakness
- Cleaving blow
- Trample (horse) the barbarians

Quartermastery

- Bless the family
- Authority of the mistress of the house
- Household harmony
- Manage a household

Exalted warrior woman devoted to the cause of the Goddess and her Conquering Daughter, Hwarin Dalthippa who saw in vision the Orlanthi defeat a lunar army. Somewhat apart among the Sisters, she was working on the inclusion of the Moon rune which she had tattooed on her forehead but didn't succeed nonetheless. Her vision later distanced her from the ongoing teachings.

Ikarnos of Raibanth

“The Lunar Way will triumph inevitably”



Figure 3. Ikarnos

- Man, 32 years old
- Standard of living: average
- Equipment: poisoned dagger, travel gear, books and writing supplies, horse

Runes



- Enigmatic, secret, elusive
- Slip through the night



- Perceptive
- Appeal to reason
- Honest



- Ambitious
- Charismatic
- Inferiority complex

Pelorian (Silver Shadow)

- Knowledge of the Empire's rules and myths (Lunar and Dara Happan)
- Read/Write New Pelorian
- Dagger combat
- Celestial Pantheon
- **Virtues:** Adaptable, Tolerant, Inclusive, Opposes the Storm Pantheon
- **Relations:**
 - Anti-Durulz (Bizarre theory about the Ducks: Water + Disorder and the Moon)

Imperial Shadow

- **Virtues:** Omerta, Self-denial, Impersonal
- Have a cover
- Blend into the crowd
- Stealth, Spotting
- Observation, Detect lies, Smell a secret
- Extract information

- Memorize
- Coded language
- **Relations:**
 - The Secret Phrases (Empire's network of informants who don't know each other but recognize each other using mysterious phrases)
 - Knowledge of the marginals
 - The Emperor (Indefectible)
 - Fazzur (Loyalty)

Diplomatica Scriptoriae (*Grimoire*)

(Subject to the lunar cycle)

- Find the path to the solution
- Make the third way triumph
- Understand any text
- Make people forget names

Lunar Charms (*Fetish*)

(Subject to the lunar cycle)

- See in the Dark (medallion)

Orphan from the slums of Raibanth who from a young age became a lunar informant, then a spy, then an Imperial Shadow, solar creations serving the hidden power. Since the death of Ignifer, he has been sidelined by the Tharkalites of Argenteus, the new Imperial Mask.

Jaridan

“War is never good for trade”



Figure 4. Jaridan

- Man, 48 years old
- **Standard of living:** comfortable
- **Wergild:** Thane
- **Equipment:** a mule, a horse, bags, merchandise, dagger, staff

Runes



- Pragmatic
- Resilient

- Pacifist, gentle, benevolent



- Travel discreetly
- Energetic
- Curious



- Diplomatic
- Empathic

Tarshite

- Basic knowledge of culture and animal husbandry
- Geography of Tarsh
- Customs & Alakoring Myths
- Knowledge of the Tula
- Storm Pantheon (without Orlanth)
- **Relations:**
 - Family
 - Clan
- **Virtues:** Courage, Generosity, Personal Honor, Social Justice, Piety, Wisdom, Vassalage

Merchant

- Numerous contacts
- Knowledge of neighboring cultures & cults (Empire + Sartar)
- Travel discreetly
- Negotiate
- Bookkeeping (accounting)
- Frugal
- Negotiate
- Evaluate goods
- Merchant's tongue

Initiate of Issaries

Communication

- Shout clearly
- Impressive speech
- Convince buyer or seller
- Soft tongue
- Speak with hands

Merchant

- Bless a market
- Create a win-win bond
- Evaluate currency
- Spot a thief
- Lock a box
- Recognize a magical object.

Initiate of Gultha Languedor

- Staff combat
- Cartography
- Orator
- Organize a caravan
- Song
- Speaks New Pelorian and Sartarite
- **Virtues:** spirit of adventure

Travel

- Cover tracks
- Detect an ambush
- Find an escape route
- Find a path
- Protection during sleep

Communication

- Make oneself understood
- Friendly greetings

Jaridan is a long-standing accomplished initiate. He therefore has enough experience to attempt whichever miracle as taught by Issaries or Gultha.

Wealthy merchant who has succeeded and wants to try to preserve his clan, his family from the future troubles to come. His wife, sons and daughters manage his trade in his absence. An entrepreneur at heart, he hopes to develop new outlets by traveling.

Peek-ee-peek

“The prophecy is coming true and our tribe was chosen a very long time ago to be the protectors of the Moon”



Figure 5. Peek

- Woman, 22 rains

- **Standard of living:** poor (relatively)
- **Equipment:** bow, lance, helmet, fetishes

Runes



- Sense of superiority
- Curious



- Sure arrow
- Sharp opinions
- Impulsive



- Sensitive
- Feel, see spirits
- Bargain with spirits

Sand Nomad

- Ride an Antelope (is one with Fta-Ah)
- Contempt for horses
- Contempt for sedentary people
- Survival in the Wastes
- Navigate
- Sense of superiority
- Customs, myths and geography of Prax
- Read Praxian knots
- Praxian Animism: Waha & Eiritha
- **Relations**
 - Tribe
 - Khan's Daughter

- **Virtues** : pride, freedom # Scout
- Stealthy
- Good sight
- Bow
- Lance

Tradition of Waha the Butcher

- **Virtues:** Eliminate Chaos, Pacification of the soul (killed animal), Nourish, defend, alert the tribe
- **Miracles:** Death Lance
- **Fetishes:**
 - Kill the stranger (do not kill for one moon after)
 - Know the lineage (sacrifice to ancestors at each full moon)
 - Beast superior to man (vegetarian)
 - Water-seeking spirit (drink nothing but water)
 - Pacification of spirits (never desecrate a place inhabited by a spirit)

Fta-Ah

- Sand Antelope
- Courageous
- Fast
- Faithful

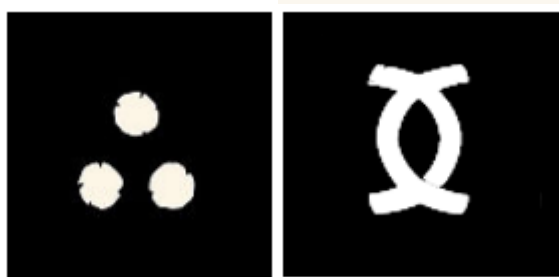
Being the only daughter of Paak-the-Cunning, he spoils her more than her brothers and allowed her to follow the guardians and hunters but as a scout. It was she who decided to head toward the Empire, hoping to trace a destiny for her people whom she estimates in danger of corruption by the Empire.

The story

The Preludes

Where we discover our heroes before they meet.

The Prelude of Ikarnos: The Shadow Beneath Argenteus's Gleam



The Rune of Mastery beats strongly in my veins; it feeds within me the devouring ambition to face all situations, to never bow my head, even though it forbids me from acting directly upon Destiny.

The world is moving, and violently. Ignifer has been killed, struck down by the infamous savage Harrek the Berserk, that cursed Wolf Pirate. But glory to the Goddess! A new Mask has been revealed to the world: it is called Argenteus. Glory to the Red Emperor! The sun of the Empire continues to shine in the skies, and the quiet shadows — of which I am part — resume their underground labors so that the Lunar Way may triumph.

However, the wind has shifted at the palace. This new Mask swept away the rigid bureaucratic scheme that prevailed during Ignifer's time. From now on, he offers the inhabitants of the Empire to savor without hindrance the prosperity and pleasure offered by the Goddess. More power to them, but I am not fooled. The enemies will be vanquished, certainly, but they must be sought out and transformed or subdued. The Shadow of Orlanth still threatens us still and always. That is precisely why my mission orders me to venture deep into barbarian lands: I must prepare the ground for our fighting forces while the people, carefree, enjoy the splendors of the Empire.

Argenteus and his entourage of courtiers seem to royally ignore this state of affairs. So I went to meet my contacts to slip them a heartfelt warning. The dialogue was lunar: while my interlocutor delighted in speaking to me of pleasures and delights, I projected in his face the imminent dangers brewing at the borders. The situation was bogging down, the dialogue was deadlocked. Disoriented by such frivolity, I then tried everything by putting forward a third way...

□ Marginal Victory

He dismissed me with a weary gesture, as if washing his hands of it. That was at least something: I did not have their official veto on my hands. Without losing a moment, I organized my journey and set course for the Southern Kingdoms.



Figure 6. Argenteus

The Prelude of Hanya: The Song of Movement and Stasis



After scrutinizing the sacred waters and completing my divinations at the well of Hwarin in Jillaro, my duty appeared to me with the clarity of crystal. I went without delay to find the priestess of the Order. The verdict of destiny was paradoxical: if one wished to protect Jillaro, I had imperatively to leave Jillaro, my beloved city, to venture forth into the dangers of the barbarian lands.

Facing her institutional skepticism, I poured out my entire soul in an attempt to open her mind to this necessity...

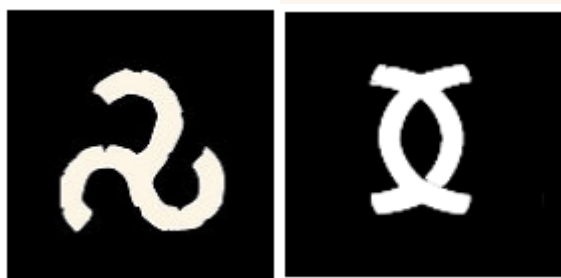


Figure 7. Hanya Prelude

□ Major Victory

The success was total. Not only did the priestess acquiesce to my arguments, but the Order decided to fully and completely support my endeavor. This would take me further from my quest toward the Red Goddess, but the defense of Civilization must take precedence. My personal case is not the most important, and this argument made the Grand Sister smile as if she saw the beginning of something.

The Prelude of Jaridan: The Bitter Scent of the Lunar Pax



Trade is my second nature, and I have the good fortune of being a regular visitor to the kingdom of Sartar, particularly with the various clans of the AldaChur confederation. But the world is changing: since the fall of Boldhome twenty years ago, the proud land of Sartar has become a Lunar Province.

It was the Dark Season, that time of year favorable to exchanging Ernalda's earthly blessings before the fury of the Storm Season descended. Confident, I guided my small caravan through the hills, taking care to visit my contacts and sometimes friends among the various clans. My goal was simple: sell my goods. But year after year, the atmosphere was degrading before my eyes. Faces hardened, people became more and more suspicious of me. Some, as I passed, even spat on the ground. What bitterness! Yet I am like them, a true Orlanthe at heart, but to no avail: my commercial past condemned me in their eyes.

The breaking point came the day I arrived on the lands of the Allalone Clan to participate in the weekly market. For the very first time in my peddler's life, I was not welcome. I had to fiercely negotiate my simple spot on the public square: what absolute shame! Me, an honest Orlanthe!



Figure 8. *Jaridan Prelude*

□ Marginal Defeat

The verdict fell, polite but implacable. My contacts, without tipping into outright hostility, refused to support me. I was formally forbidden from displaying my wares on the market. Out of regard for our shared past, they insisted that this was not an attack against me personally, but against what I now represented in their eyes. They nonetheless offered me hospitality for the night before asking me to leave.

In the darkness, quietly, I still managed to sell a few goods to clan members who came to find me discreetly out of sight. But what immense sadness... The clans are divided, grimly turned inward, unable to see the obvious benefits they could derive from the *Lunar Pax*. Oh, I understand their point of view, their pride... but their struggle is futile. We know this well, in Tarsh. All of this will only lead to new unnecessary bloodbaths, and meanwhile, trade withers.

The Prelude of Peek-ee-peek: Blood and Dust of Bullion-of-Moon



Our tribe carved its glory in blood during the memorable Battle of Bullion-of-Moon. I was there! And by the spirits, what a Homeric battle! On one side, the lunar army, resplendent in gleaming weapons and armor, magic crackling in the ether and terrifying dragon-men out of legends. On the other, us, proud, terrible, cleaving the plain on the backs of our war antelopes! We literally crushed the other tribes.

My clan's mission was crucial: we had to form a bulwark around the Lunar wizards and protect their precious mystical resources from enemy assaults.

□ The battle was played as an advanced opposition in HQ/G

The enemy charged. My fingers clenched on my bowstring, I loosed my arrows to keep them at bay.

The horde did not retreat, they were damn numerous. Gritting our teeth, we continued to pepper them with arrows under a sky of death.

The storm of steel raged around us. Our wall of arrows continued to prevent the foot soldiers from reaching the imperial wizards who, in the rear, were performing terrifying feats of fire and light. But the pressure was too strong.

The front lines were breached! Seeing the enemy warriors closing in on us, I decided to drop the arrows and summon the *Spirit of the Beast*, projecting the wild wave to knock the attackers from their mounts.

Some riders tumbled into the dust, but the human tide remained too dense. I persevered, screaming my incantations until my throat tore.

This time, the impact made them reconsider. In the chaos, I saw them trying to regroup. No question of giving them time to catch their breath! I decided to push my advantage to destabilize them once and for all. Without their mounts, these dogs are nothing, they are as vulnerable as we would be without our antelopes!

The defense line held firm, but the balance was precarious, everything could still tip at any moment.

The fury of combat reached its peak, the smell of blood mingled with the intoxicating taste of a victory that was close at hand. That was when the tide turned.

Our line gave way, broken by a desperate assault. Overwhelmed, I cried out to Fta-Ah, my faithful mount, to tear us from the melee and give us a moment of shelter.

It was so close to snatching the victory... Fta-Ah, admirable in loyalty, allowed me to maneuver in the heart of the chaos, rearing up and unseating the riders who surrounded us.

The law of war is cruel and forgives no lapse.

Then, the surge! Hooray! Seeing the enemy ranks finally falter, I tried to push my ultimate advantage by casting my *Death Lance* at one of the fleeing. It was a high-lama, one of their great leaders without a doubt, given the abundance of fetishes and sacred tattoos adorning his skin.

My ultimate feat of glory failed by a hair... I could have been the legendary heroine of that day. But what does personal prestige matter, for in the end, we had won!

It was a **major defeat** for the attackers. The nomad tribes that had rushed to assault the lunar positions were lastingly broken by this disaster — crippled, handicapped, and morally demoralized for the seasons to come.

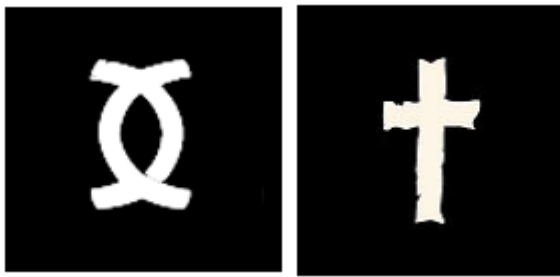


Figure 9. Battle of Bullion of Moon

As for me, I came out alive but greatly weakened, my body marked by a few bloody abrasions and my mind emptied by a deep spiritual exhaustion from having called upon the Spirit of the Beast so much. Fta-Ah, exhausted by her exploits, is equally weakened. But what do our wounds matter: our victory at the Battle of Bullion-of-Moon remains absolute and historic.

Dunstop

Fazzur's Mission



- **Location:** Dunstop — Palace of provincial general *Fazzur the Learned*
- **Date:** 1611 — Sea Season — Harmony Week — Clay Day

The Audience with the General

Ikarnos

After 3 days of waiting in the city of Dunstop — so far from Raibanth, so different, so military — I was finally admitted to the palace to meet with Fazzur. He was aware of my arrival as the Emperor had informed him and he knew I would be at his service. So I left my writings in suspense and my study of the *Rashoran path* to arrive before Yelm's zenith.

The palace was not grand, nor ostentatious like imperial palaces, and resembled more of a barracks with its contingent of guards, checkpoints... I wondered where Fazzur got his nickname of “the Learned,” for I could hardly see a library in such a place, unless the nickname came from an extensive network of informants. I prepared for the interview through meditation.

□ Marginal Defeat □ No increase

Fazzur received me standing in his office. A fine crafted table was covered with maps and tokens of all kinds, no doubt simulating future battles for this so talented general, with his hard and self-assured face. Beside him stood three other characters:

- A warrior woman with a shaved head and determined gaze.
- A lunarsed barbarian of sturdy build (perhaps a merchant).
- A nomad woman of proud bearing, **but strongly smelling**.

Strange assembly.

“Greetings to you Fazzur, the conqueror!” I saw the warrior woman smile. “May the Goddess be praised for allowing our earthly paths to cross.”

He replied: “May we satisfy the Son of the Moon, and welcome to you in Dunstop.” He paused and pointed at the map before him: “Here is Prax, the Empire's newest victory. An arid land populated by Nomads, like **Peek-ee-Peek** who belongs to the tribe devoted to our Goddess, but the other tribes

are our enemies. We have vanquished them, but peace remains fragile and must be consolidated.”

I looked at the nomad from head to toe and shuddered at the thought that it was people like her who, several times, put the Empire to fire and sword, even assassinating the Emperor.



Figure 10. Fazzur

“Even though it is difficult to win a war, it is equally difficult to maintain and impose peace,” Fazzur continued. “War leaves scars, resentment among the vanquished and they always seek revenge. We will crush them if necessary, but we must be prepared. That is why I need you four to consolidate our positions, to be my eyes and ears. Snoop, investigate, represent our cause. You have free rein. Return in one year to make your report. You may leave.”

“I accept willingly,” I said.

“Here is my seal, Ikarnos. I do not know you but the Emperor trusts you, so that is enough for me. You will thus be able to act in my name. Do not disappoint me. Seek out the threats but also sources of alliance or magical resources. We will prevail.”

“We will prevail and the Emperor will glorify your successes, Fazzur. Might I take some time to prepare our **luminescent journey**?”

Staring at Fazzur, I awaited his reaction for I had used a *secret word*. If the latter was connected, I would know immediately.

□ Marginal Victory

The Negotiations and the Agreement

My new companions were not to be outdone:

Jaridan launched into a diatribe about the dangers of being unprepared, making many hand gestures (I learned later these were gestures to establish a “win-win link” that initiates of his God **Issaries** learn).

Hanya adopted a grandiloquent tone to remind of her commitment to the Goddess and the cause. She approved with a pout, confirming that the barbarian was right: even though quick action is often the source of success, many expeditions had failed for lack of taking the necessary time.

The nomad observed and said nothing.

□ Confrontation outcome: major victory

Fazzur did not respond to the secret word, but he agreed to let me spend some time looking at the maps. He also allocated us a **substantial purse** intended to create fruitful connections or to *corrupt weak souls*.

I was discovering the resources of my new companions and was rather satisfied with their profile. They seemed committed to the lunar cause. So we took our leave of Fazzur, thanking him, assuring him we would be worthy of his trust. I announced I would return the next day to consult a few maps. We left the palace to go to a tavern on the square to get acquainted and plan a route.

Immersions & Preparations

At the inn, we got acquainted and each person shared a little about their life and their relationship with the **Red Moon**.

Hanya seemed a bit haughty and looked down on Jaridan and Peek-ee-Peek, but she seemed trustworthy.

Jaridan confessed that he wanted peace above all. I promised to do everything in that direction, but deep down, I knew that *excesses were sometimes necessary* to make the cause triumph.

Peek-ee-Peek spoke little. She did not master Pelorian well, but she spoke of a **prophecy received by her people more than 50 rains ago**, stating that *the wind was rising*.

The Choice of Route

According to Jaridan, the safest but longest route to reach Prax was to take a detour through the north to bypass the mountains and reach **AldaChur**.

Hanya, for her part, invoked the **Conquering Daughter** and seemed motivated to find another

route, faster and more direct, through the south.

Peek-ee-Peek, true to herself, *did not like roads*. We finally decided to copy the necessary maps the next day at Fazzur's palace.

The afternoon was occupied preparing the expedition: provisions, mules, horses. I was not a good rider, but travel would be easier on horseback. Hanya and Peek-ee-Peek seemed more at ease with their mounts.

Note: Peek-ee-peek traveled mounted on her **Antelope**, which she watched constantly through the inn window. She declared that **Fta-ah** (her antelope) and she did not like horses, and that she would ride ahead, as a scout.

Jaridan shrugged and laughed. I understood that our companion was eager to get going.

The Departure

That evening, we slept at Fazzur's palace: our expedition was thus safe. The next morning, we went up to see Fazzur who gave us a list of potentially useful contacts.

I copied my two maps:

1. One of the northern kingdom of **Sartar**
2. One of **Prax**

We decided to depart at dawn the next day. Our group debated for quite some time over the direction to take, but we finally opted for **the southern road**.

In Jaridan's and my opinion, it seemed the route *shortest in distance*, but undoubtedly **the longest in time and the most dangerous above all!**

Bagnot

From Dunstop to Bagnot



Date: 1611 – Sea Season – Harmony Week – Clay Day

We left Dunstop with a lunar squad that was heading to Bagnot to relieve the guard at the *Temple of the Quaking Earth*. From the start, the atmosphere was heavy: the soldiers' comments openly criticized Peek-ee-Peek. A small core of soldiers, led by one of their number who was particularly xenophobic, fueled the most rancid prejudices: nomad zoophilia, the supposed submission of sand

men to their “females,” etc.

The journey was off to a bad start and these tensions risked compromising our safety. Although she did not stoop to the soldiers’ level, Hanya did not come to the nomad’s defense either. She judged her boorish, swearing only by the beauty of civilization of which Jillaro was one of many jewels. Jaridan, for his part, tried to speak to the nomad, but she, on the defensive, would not let him approach with his horse.

The tension was at its peak when we made camp for the night. We hesitated to camp separately; but on the one hand, the danger would be greater, and on the other, I wanted to talk with the soldiers to learn more about Sartar and Prax.

During the journey

Ikarnos’s Objective: Obtain any intelligence about threats within the Empire.

□ Marginal Defeat

Ikarnos’s account: “I tried to speak with the decurion commanding the squad to see what he knew about threats and our enemies, but I obtained no information worthy of the name.”

Peek-ee-Peek’s Objective: Send *Spirit of the Beast* at the racist soldier’s mount to cause an accident.

□ Marginal Victory

Peek-ee-Peek’s account: “I tried to cause an accident to the soldier who had been disrespectful to me all day. The spirits accompany me and guide my path. So I whispered to *Spirit of the Beast* to go make the decurion’s horse suddenly rear and kick the soldier. The horse reared, but the soldier was not hit, and the decurion did not fall either. The event seemed strange to all and cast a great silence in the ranks. At least they stopped bothering me and became cautious, believing an invisible enemy was nearby. Scouts were dispatched. We lost time, but I smiled inwardly: I had obtained calm.”



Figure 11. From Dunstop to Bagnot

Jaridan's and Hanya's Objectives: Nothing special.

Stopover at Bagnot



Date: 1611 – Sea Season – Harmony Week – Wind Day

After the previous day's incident with the decurion's horse, we decided to push harder on horseback and continue our journey without the squad. This choice proved worthwhile: we were able to reach Bagnot within the day.

During the trip, we discussed the group and how we should support each other to prevent the previous day's problems from recurring. Peek-ee-Peek then confessed that it was she who had made the horse rear, though she regretted not having managed to blind the soldier. Facing our remarks, she agreed to make efforts to allow us to approach our mounts near her antelope, despite the deep contempt she held for horses.

Then we finally spotted the stone fortifications of Bagnot, the former capital of the kingdom of Tarsh, before the kings settled at World's End. We also learned that the new king, Pharandros, was currently visiting the city. Armed with Fazzur's seal and our list of contacts, we were in a good position to meet him: Pharandros was none other than Fazzur's nephew, and he had just barely ascended to the throne.

Immersion in the city

The city appeared of clearly Orlanthi inspiration and much less military than Dunstop. Jaridan, the Tarshite merchant, already had some commercial contacts there. Hanya remained doubtful, not finding the splendor of her beloved Jillaro, although she was told of the *Temple of Arim the Poor*, perhaps the only notable construction in the city.

We decided to go to Caius Brontex, a magistrate and friend of Fazzur on our list. He welcomed our small party in his home, whose exterior architecture was Orlanthi but whose interior furnishing was purely Dara Happan. Around a table, we discussed with Caius the regional situation. We gleaned several pieces of information:

- The *Lunar Pax* is fragile (but we already knew that).
- The young king Pharandros is particularly ambitious.
- He holds immense admiration for Fazzur for his military genius.
- He is in favor of strict and ruthless application of lunar laws, even in barbarian provinces, to "better educate" them (use of pillories, mass sending of slaves to the *Slave Wall*, crucifixions...).

We asked him about the interest of choosing an eastern route rather than bypassing through the north. Caius, who ventured very little outside his city, had no firm opinion on the matter, though he himself would have preferred the main road for obvious reasons of comfort and security.

Companions' Activities

Hanya went to visit the *Temple of Arim the Poor*. She found herself alone among the barbarians. The temple was nothing exceptional in itself, but its wooden sculptures detailed the journey of this man who became a God, who had the courage to be the first to enter the *Dragon Pass* after the draconic killings. The bas-reliefs showed his various and mysterious encounters: a centaur, a woman with feathers on her head, or a priestess and a mountain.

Jaridan took the opportunity to sell a few goods and renew his commercial stocks.

Peek-ee-Peek preferred to keep a low profile and stayed most of the time sheltered at Caius's place.

The royal audience

We decided to send only myself (Ikarnos) and Hanya as ambassadors to Pharandros. We did not know the new king's exact disposition toward non-lunar people, and the altercation with the squad encouraged us to be cautious.

So I had myself announced alongside Hanya to Pharandros. The king was young, handsome, charismatic, sporting curly blond hair and a contagious smile. We were perfectly received, for in his eyes, "*friends of his uncle were necessarily so.*" The young sovereign was surrounded by

advisors often much older than him, but I quickly noticed that they did not seem to dominate him for all that.

I presented our mission which brought me to travel to the lands of Prax, recently conquered. The young king's vision was clear: by bringing the lunar benefits to local populations, they would almost naturally cease to be a threat, while using force of course if necessary.



Figure 12. Pharandros

Suddenly, one of the advisors asked me what the Emperor's *Undulating Mask* would think of the cult of Arim the Poor. I immediately recognized a secret word: my interlocutor was no doubt a member of the *Society of Secret Phrases*. I stared at him intently. He was a thin, almost ascetic man, wearing a robe and carrying several scroll cases.

It was **Hanya** who spoke up to answer him: "The Goddess only fights her enemies and knows how to recognize the qualities of all in everything, for we are but One in her eyes!"

The man smiled mischievously: "Indeed, you are right, noble guardian of Jillaro. I was merely making a joke comparing the austerity of poor Arim to the current lifestyle of the new mask."

The audience ended on these words. It was obvious that I needed to contact this man again more discreetly. We left the king, informing him that we were staying at Caius's home and would remain a few days here to prepare our expedition toward Prax through the east. All that remained was to wait.

Back at the house, we told everything to Jaridan and Peek-ee-Peek. I had chosen to include them in the secret to bond our rather heterogeneous group. Hanya was of the opinion to be wary: in her

eyes, Jaridan and Peek-ee-Peek not being “one of us,” they could have reasons to betray us, and it was better they knew as little as possible. She agreed, however, that the information gathered was far from confidential.

Peek-ee-Peek: “You are strange to want to stay locked behind walls. But I will wait if it is the Goddess’s will.”

We went to sleep in Caius’s spacious house, who proved to be an exceedingly considerate host.

Secret meeting at the Lunarium

The next day, I met the advisor at the city’s thermal baths. The latter, newly erected, had been inaugurated by the king a few days earlier (which explained his visit to Bagnot, as a way to establish his reign through a civilizing vision). I was accompanied by Jaridan.



Figure 13. Lunarium

It was in the heart of the red smoke of the *Lunarium* that the man reappeared. I noticed there were very few locals in the baths. He finally introduced himself: “**Imex Rapiis**, strategic and tactical advisor to the King. Pharandros is young and still discovering the barbarian world. This is not the Empire here, but merely a province. Fortunately, it is the richest of the Provinces. I am here so that Prosperity reigns, so that barbarian chiefs have no interest in rebelling, and so that the *Lunar Pax* persists. That is why we built these Thermal Baths.”

Turning to Jaridan, he added: “It is the choice between victory with us, or defeat against us, so to

peak.”

I decided to advance my pieces:

Ikarnos: “However, taxes, levies, and slaves must be sent to the Empire. The balance is not simple to find.”

Imex Rapiis: “As I told you, the Province is rich, so the situation could be far worse. You are courageous to venture forth like this. On the other side of the mountains lies the famous *Dragon Pass*: a territory of hills and summits, a mosaic of peoples that are essentially barbarian, but also non-human. Here in Tarsh, we have a few exiles in the mountains who revolt from time to time. But over there, on the other side, it must be hell, even though we vanquished them almost ten years ago. Be cautious, my friends, in any case.”

Departure

We departed a few days later heading for the mountains, marching toward what was indicated on our maps as the **Falling Ruins** — the only passage allowing access to the *Dragon Pass* without having to bypass through the North.

On the Road to the Falling Ruins

Destination: The Falling Ruins

Party members: Hanya, Peek-ee-Peek, Ikarnos & Jiridan

The Exiles' Ambush



We were advancing on our mounts along an increasingly wild road, drawing closer to the mountains, when suddenly arrows flew. We were under attack!

Hanya cried out: “**The Exilés!!!**” We looked around and saw a dozen armed men approaching. Four remained in reserve with their bows, while eight others advanced, armed with axes and protected by small round shields bearing the runes of **Air** and **Movement**. They wore tunics and animal skins — bear or wolf, perhaps. “**Death to Shipelkirt!**” they shouted.

□ **Resolution - Impact of the 1st volley of arrows:** * **Conflict:** - Attackers: **1** (Arrows) - Heroes: **1** (Antelope sense & Peek-ee-Peek) + **1** (Hanya: Safe route)

* **Result 1 vs 2:** Tie therefore setback

Peek-ee-Peek’s antelope stopped dead before the attack and Hanya traced a sign of protection in the

air. Combat is inevitable.

We were thus surprised by a volley of arrows which, fortunately, did not hit their target thanks to our vigilance. But it was too late to devise a battle plan: we had to react immediately.

The melee and the hostage ruse

□ **Resolution - First contact:** * **Conflict:** - Attackers: 1 (Arrows) + 1 (Numerical superiority) + 1 (Hatred of the Empire) + 1 (Fierce) + 1 (Axes) = 5 - Heroes: 1 (Hanya) + 1 (Peek-ee-Peek) + 1 (Mounted) = 3 * **Result 5 vs 3:** Heroes defeated by -1.

The noose was tightening dangerously around us. Fortunately, the proximity of the melee now prevented the enemy archers from shooting at us without risking hitting their own.

Ikarnos and Jiridan tried to distance themselves from the heart of the confrontation. Ikarnos approached Jiridan, grabbed his wrists and passed a small cord around them.

Ikarnos: “They will think you are our prisoner if things go badly. You will take that opportunity to intervene.” Ikarnos then tied a rope between his horse and Jiridan’s. The maneuver, done discreetly, unfortunately drew the exiles’ suspicion and the archers’ fire upon them.

□ **Resolution - The archers against Ikarnos & Jiridan:** * **Conflict:** - Archers: 1 (Bows) + 1 (Position advantage) - Heroes: 1 (Mounted) + 1 (Jiridan’s Ruse: “`Don’t shoot!”) \* **Result 2 vs 2: Heroes victory at `+2.**

Jiridan immediately understood the tactical advantage Ikarnos had just offered him. He cried out in the Orlanthi tongue: “Don’t shoot! Free me, I am their prisoner!” This made the archers hesitate, who immediately ceased their fire.

The Red Moon’s dance of death

Meanwhile, Hanya and Peek-ee-Peek faced the melee group.

□ **Resolution - Hanya & Peek in close combat:** * **Conflict:** - Attackers: 1 (Axes) + 1 (Numbers) + 1 (Vengeful) + 1 (Fierce) - Heroes: 1 (Hanya) + 1 (Goddess’s Grace) + 1 (Peek) + 1 (Mounted) + 1 (Antelope) * **Result 4 vs 5:** Brilliant heroes victory at +4.

Hanya and Peek-ee-Peek put on a masterful display of their talent. The antelope leapt over two guards. In mid-flight, Peek pierced one of the attackers with her lance. Hanya, for her part, fought with a hypnotic grace, spinning her mount and her sword, cutting throat after throat.

Red blood sprayed, offering a striking aesthetic echo, in perfect harmony with the **Red Moon** shining proudly in the sky. Peek charged three times to eliminate the remaining rebels. Panicked, the archers fled.

Hanya sheathed her weapon: “Should we pursue them?”

Ikarnos shook his head: “No. Their cowardice will once again be proof of the Goddess’s superiority.”

The interrogation and the forgetting spell

We dismounted. **Ikarnos** winked at Jiridan: “Let us maintain the illusion as long as we are not certain we are out of danger.”

Jiridan thus remained in the saddle, pretending to be bound, while examining the bodies of the attackers.

There were 4 dead, 3 dying, and 1 gravely wounded. Hanya coldly finished off the dying.

Jiridan then whispered in Ikarnos’s ear: “I recognized some faces. I saw them at the market in Bagnot. The rebels are thus also present in the city, and not just in the mountains...”

Ikarnos approached the sole survivor: “Do you want to live or die?”

The man stammered: “Glory to Orlanth!”, before spitting out more words in Orlanthi. His eyes widened in shock when he saw Jiridan translate his words.

Inspiration: Revelation

The prisoner had said: “The Hero Wars have begun, and Argrath will bring the Goddess to her knees.”

Ikarnos: “Interesting. And where can we find this Argrath?”

The man: “It is he who will find you. He will rip out your guts, son of a dog!”

Ikarnos: “That is brave of you not to beg for your salvation. Your arm is badly mangled... You could have made a useful slave in the gardens of a patrician. Only, we are not here for that. My choice is delicate, understand? What to do with a vanquished enemy: kill him, or let him live so he can continue the fight?”

Jiridan understood that Ikarnos was playing with his prey. On one hand, it seemed cruel to him; on the other, he was fascinated by this typically Lunar ability to never make things simple or binary.

A glimmer of terror finally passed through the rebel’s gaze, as if he suddenly realized the darkness of his fate.

Ikarnos then murmured a few phrases in **Old Dara-happan**, then asked the man gently: “Remind me, friend... What is the God you serve? And what is the name of this ‘hero’ who must vanquish the Great Goddess?”

□ **Resolution - Spell “Forget the names” against the survivor: * Conflict: -**
Ikarnos 1 (Spell) + 1 (Position of strength) - 1 (Rebel’s Will) * **Result 2 vs 1:**
Ikarnos victory at +1.

The prisoner stammered: “Glory to... He... will conquer...” Suddenly, tears flowed down his cheeks. He had just realized, with horror, that he was unable to pronounce the names of his Gods and his Heroes. The magical forgetting was total.



Figure 14. Forgetting of Orlanth's Name

Ikarnos smiled: “If you survive, go to Bagnot, to the temple of Danfive Xaron. You will find a new life there. Or else, return among your people, and beg them for mercy for no longer being able to worship your own Gods...”

We left the prisoner on the spot, leaving him some water and a few provisions, before resuming our road toward the mountain, redoubling our vigilance.

Debriefing and crossing the Shining Line

During the march, we took stock of this encounter. Should we report the information to **Fazzur** or to the Tarshite authorities? The Exiles were an ancient reality in the kingdom. Having been attacked by a group that had probably spotted us in Bagnot was not crucial information for the overall fight against the Rebellion.

Jiridan thanked Ikarnos for sparing the man, even though he remained considerably shocked by the nature of the magic used. Hanya remained dignified and silent. Peek-ee-Peek, for her part, considered the enemy group pathetic, claiming that the strength of our party rested solely on her and Hanya.

We agreed that we now needed to travel more discreetly. Our goal was not to suppress the local rebellion, but to transport resources for the Empire, particularly in **Prax**. Even though this required crossing the fearsome **Dragon Pass**, we were only at the beginning of our journey and we knew many obstacles would try to distract us from our objective.

That was when we crossed the **Shining Line**.

A certain apprehension seized the group: once this magical frontier was crossed, we would be fully subject to the phases of the Red Moon. The crossing was like passing through an invisible wall. On one side, the sky bore slightly reddish tints; on the other, it was a brilliant blue and the wind blew much harder. Ikarnos and Hanya were the most impressed by this phenomenon, having never known any sky other than that of the heart of the Empire. Conversely, Jiridan and Peek-ee-Peek found the open sky they had always known.

The Busérian Astrolabes have long discoursed on the phases of the Moon. Indeed, according to their astral logic, the Full Moon is intrinsically unstable: it is full, but empties by half in a single day. It then diminishes more slowly during Water Day, which seems to act as a slowing, plunging it into its dying phase. According to Ikarnos, this phenomenon is undoubtedly related to his personal theory about the **Durulz** (the Ducks).

Tensions at the bivouac - The Spirits vs The Moon

We now traveled off the beaten path, on our guard. Peek-ee-Peek went ahead as a scout and signaled if the way was clear. As we approached the mountains, we carefully avoided isolated dwellings. However, the region was not deserted, and encounter was inevitable.

  Enemy and relations. What is different threatens our cohesion.

During a bivouac at the foot of the mountains, while Peek was chanting shamanic incantations while playing with a round, painted pebble, Hanya suddenly turned on her. She stated that for the good of the mission, it would be preferable for all members of the party to be devoted to the Red Goddess and abandon their old superstitious cults.

She then looked at Jiridan, telling him plainly that she was not speaking about him — the old God of trade (Issaries) being respectable — but that she did not understand how Peek-ee-Peek, who claimed to have had a revelation for the Goddess, could continue practicing her “spirit stuff.” In her view, Peek would benefit from fully embracing the Moon.

The situation immediately became very tense. In response, Peek-ee-Peek drew an arrow bound to a spirit capable of killing Hanya on the spot if she ordered it, then spat on the ground. Hanya then tried to win Ikarnos’s support by advancing various theological arguments.

□ **Resolution - Convince Peek-ee-Peek:** * *Note: The obstacle here is clearly Hanya. Her points thus feed the antagonism (Aggressor vs Aggressed). We are at the 1st Quarter, lunar magic is thus normal.* * **Conflict:** - Conversion attempt: 1 (Willing or not) + 1 (Openness of mind) - Resistance: 1 (Superiority complex) + 1 (Haughty Hanya) + 1 (Traditionalist) * **Result 2 vs 3:** Peek

defeated by -1.

Peek-ee-Peek listened and grew angry. The debate became acrimonious, and the mercenary (Hanya), transformed into a true missionary, seemed possessed by a sacred fervor. Facing her, Peek-ee-Peek struggled to formulate her arguments.

As the tone rose dangerously, Ikarnos intervened. He firmly reminded them that **Jakaleel the Sorceress** had been one of the **Seven Mothers** who brought the Goddess back to life 500 years ago. The Red Goddess had integrated spirits into her vision of the world, just as she had done with everything else: her friends as well as her enemies, mages as well as priests, and even Chaos. We are far too small to apprehend such immensity.

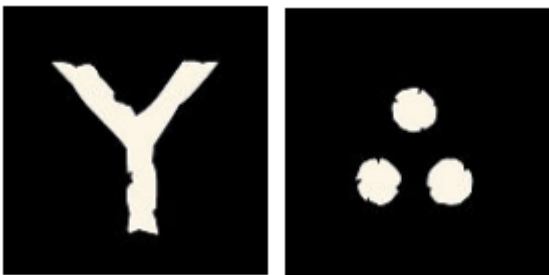
Forced to reflect, Peek-ee-Peek had to admit that she still knew nothing of the vast world. Ikarnos managed to calm both women by making Peek promise to meet a shaman or shamaness of Jakaleel as soon as the opportunity arose. Thus, she would not deny her nature, would continue to honor the spirit way, while drawing closer to the Goddess to one day guide the **Sable People** toward their fulfillment.

Peek-ee-Peek relaxed and shared with us an old story: how, several centuries ago, the Sable People (who originally possessed the Earth rune) abandoned it to adopt that of the **New Moon**, because it reminded them of the horns of the antelopes they rode.

“That is how, quite naturally, the Empire became their ally during the great battle of Prax,” concluded **Ikarnos**, who had studied the chronicles of Fazzur’s campaign in detail. Thanks to this alliance, they were today the most powerful tribe of the five Praxian tribes.

Ikarnos flattered Peek-ee-Peek’s pride a bit, hinting that she might well be one of those heroines destined to change the destiny of an entire people. The evening ended in a much more serene atmosphere than it had begun.

The Falling Ruins



Expected themes: Mysterious ruins, a strange story of a scholar from the WFH (Empire of Friends of Wyrms), blocks of stone falling from the sky, the meeting with Elemenoria.

On the road to the barbarian worlds

Our heroes continue to advance toward the mountains and have left the woods of the Tarsh plain. Still on their guard and taking every precaution, they begin to climb the foothills through a fir

forest. The temperature drops drastically and the winds gain in violence. They have left the comfortable space of the Empire, which had managed to enslave the climate. They are now truly on the road to the barbarian worlds.

The firs become increasingly rare, giving way to a rocky stone trail leading toward a pass. Suddenly, strange ruined structures appear on the horizon.

Ikarnos (having inquired beforehand): “My companions, there are the Falling Ruins!”

Hanya: “It must have been gigantic and magnificent...”

Ikarnos: “The Empire of Friends of Wyrms had built one of its cities here... before the arrival of the Dragons.”

Peek: “Dragons? There are Dragons here???”

Jaridan (laughing nervously): “Let’s hope not! More seriously, nobody mentioned them to me at the market in Bagnot. The pass is used by travelers. If there were such a danger, everyone would talk about it, right? At least, I hope so...”

Nobody is truly reassured. They enter the city at a walk. The builders of the WFH thought big. Our heroes venture deeper into this immense and haunted place, made of illogical constructions: wide streets leading to dead ends, paths going in circles. All urban logic seems to have deserted the place, which deeply disturbs Ikarnos. Peek, for her part, curses these piles of stone.

Suddenly, a block of several tons crashes right in front of them, followed by a rain of rocks!

□ Obstacle: Falling rocks of the scale - Conflict: - Dying Moon: weakened lunar power - Surprise (1), Immense (1) - Antelope (1), Safe route (1) - Result 2 vs 2: Defeat at -1.

Peek: “Watch out, rocks!!!” she screams, abruptly stopping her mount. Our four heroes scan the sky. The rocks fall from nowhere.

Hanya: “They must be eagles... Look for flying monsters, take cover and bring them down!” But the sky is desperately empty of enemies.

□ Second volley: - Conflict: - Dying Moon: weakened lunar power - Falling rocks (1), metal rivets (1) - Trying to take shelter (1) Result 2 vs 1: Defeat at -1.

The group realizes that the chaotic layout of the city is not only due to the eccentricity of its builders, but also to these deadly downpours.

Peek: “I see nothing in the air. Who is attacking us??”

Jaridan: “What if we tried to advance to escape the impact zone?”

Ikarnos: “Let’s go!!!”

□ The breakout: - Conflict: - Dying Moon: weakened lunar power - Rocks (1), increasingly intense (1) - Each hero uses an asset (Mastery, Movement, or Antelope) and benefits from a lull (1). Results of the 2 vs 2: Success +2

Taking advantage of a brief lull, Ikarnos keeps his composure, Hanya and Jaridan slip through with agility, and Peek launches her antelope through the debris. After a frantic 200-meter run, they reach an elevated district. Stupefied, they watch the stones continue to crash exactly where they just left. Without trying to understand this marvel, Ikarnos orders to move away as quickly as possible to find the pass.



Figure 15. Falling stones

The witch of the Ruins

Night falls. In the distance, Peek-ee-Peek spots a wisp of smoke. Desperate from going in circles in this ascending maze, they approach it with caution. Around a mountain-side alley, they discover an old woman and a young girl sitting near a fire.

As they try to hide, the old woman speaks: “Approach, Mortals, do not be afraid. You came for this. Come share my meager meal, even though I sense that earthly nourishment is not what you seek.”

Jaridan (whispering): “Let’s stay on guard.”

Ikarnos: “Who are you, old woman?”

The old woman (toothless smile): “I am known as Elemenoria. But a name is only a name; what matters is what one makes of it and what it means to those who hear it.”

Ikarnos: “You speak in riddles. Are you a lunatic?”

Elemenoria: “Light and shadow are two sides of the same coin, but that coin is yours. Mine is called rather reality and dream.”

Peek-ee-Peek: “I don’t like this woman, we should leave.”

Hanya: “That is not for you to decide.”

In a heavy silence, the heroes share the roasted meat offered by the woman. They notice that the girl, about ten years old, has the vacant gaze of the blind.

Elemenoria breaks the silence: “Do you know why this place is so special? Have you ever seen a dragon? When a true dragon dreams, it becomes reality, and it is this reality that mortals perceive. Long ago, men believed they could mingle with them. They created an Empire. One of them came here, and I was his servant. His dream was to build the tallest ladder in the world to navigate between the domain of the Gods and that of men. But where there is dreaming, there is waking... The Dragons awoke. The ladder was destroyed, and its pieces still fall and always will. That is what reality is!”

Jaridan: “But how old are you? The Empire disappeared 500 years ago!”

Elemenoria: “Mortals die, but power is passed on. Do you have a dream, merchant? Have no fear, the place is safe. I can grant one wish for each of you. A final wish for the long road that awaits us all, in a sense,” she said with a strange gleam in her eye.

She extends her hand. A globe of light envelops her and the girl.

The wishes of destiny

Hanya the ambitious enters first. Inside, silence is absolute.



Hanya: “I believe you are nothing but a joke, you crazy old woman. Prove me otherwise. I would dream, for example, of being fast enough that no projectile could reach me.” Proud of her impossible wish, she smiles.

The old woman replies to her: “So be it, but know that every wish has a price. Each time a projectile would have hit you, yes, you will avoid it, but somewhere another will be struck!”

Hanya left the luminous globe a bit puzzled.

Jaridan asks Hanya who replies: “just go see for yourself.” So Jaridan is the next to enter the silent globe.



Jaridan: “I dream that in these troubled times, yesterday’s enemies become friends at best or at least allies. I think it is impossible but I have always dreamed of it and that is why I am with these Lunars.”

The old woman: “What a noble dream, Jaridan. There exists a time and place where this dream will come true, but if you wish to reach it, you will have to renounce your family and never see them again! Are you willing to do that? Are they willing to do that?”

And Jaridan comes out, devastated by what he just heard. Next is **Ikarnos**.



The woman: “The time is no longer for words but for revelations. You, tell me what you desire!”

Ikarnos: “I would wish to obtain the power of Dragons then,” he said, hoping thus to put on the Empire’s side a terrible power to fight its enemies.

The woman smiles: “I expected as much. So be it. The Dragons are waiting anyway to intervene. Hidden, patiently, infinitely, they observe you, and you will be able to speak to them in due time. But.. hahaha.. what is funny is that when that happens, you will have switched sides!”

Ikarnos: “Curse it, what are you saying??”

The woman: “I say nothing, I reveal your destiny.”

And so Ikarnos exits as troubled as his three companions.

Peek-ee-Peek finally enters the globe.

She sits down and asks: “Are you made of flesh and bone, or are you a spirit?”

The old woman squints: “We are daughters of destiny, and have you ever seen a blind spirit?”

Suddenly, Peek grips her lance. “Die, Witch!!!”

□ Peek’s attack against Elemenoria - Conflict: - Lance, surprise, kill the enemy - Clairvoyant - Result 3 vs 1: Victory +2

The lance pierces Elemenoria’s heart, who tries to whisper a final curse.

Peek drives the blade in with rage: “May your death be the swiftest!”

The globe dissipates instantly. The witch has disappeared. Only the blind little girl remains who jumps up and rushes into a crevice in the wall.



Figure 16. Elemenoria

□ Stop the girl - Conflict: - Warrior, blind little girl - Agile, the others shout “No!” - Result 2 vs 2: Failure

The others throw themselves on Peek to restrain her.

Jaridan: “Fool! What have you done? The opening is too small, she will warn others. We must flee!”

Ikarnos: “Saddle up. But tonight, Peek, you will have to explain yourself!”

The Dragon Pass and the Gazzams’ fury

The heroes gallop down the slopes in darkness, fleeing the crime scene. At dawn, they reach the foothills of the Dragon Pass. To the south, thick mist; to the north, hills; before them, the kingdom of Sartar.

The murder of a stranger prevents Peek from killing during a full moon (constraint of the protective spirit).

The heroes advance, having descended for hours at a steady but cautious pace given the darkness and the steep slope. At dawn, they discover the new geography before them. It is an opportunity to rest a bit after an anxious flight and especially an opportunity for Ikarnos to question the nomad.

Ikarnos: “What have you done, fool! You murdered her coldly.”

Jaridan: “Back home, do you allow yourselves to kill those with whom you share bread?”

Hanya: “I have always said it, barbarians can be civilized but nomads are still primitives that must be subdued or eliminated.”

Peek spits: “You are the fools.. I saw you come back from your meeting, you all looked different. Oh yes, they grant wishes. Haha.. what did she promise you? Come on, tell me and I will tell you why I killed her and then you will thank me,” says the nomad without being shaken.

Hanya: “no more arrow will be able to reach me.”

Jaridan: “peace will be possible between yesterday’s enemies.”

Ikarnos: “I could master the powers of Dragons.”

Peek: “Hahaha.. well then! Either she is a madwoman and her death will be regretted by no one, or she tells the truth and I have thus prevented another from coming with the wish to destroy the Goddess. That is why I killed her. You know everything.. you only think of your glory without seeing the danger this woman represented.”

Then she falls into silence. Ikarnos, Hanya, and Jaridan begin to deliberate. Suddenly an arrow is launched at Hanya!! It is Peek.

□ Peek’s arrow - Conflict: - Very good archer (2), surprise (1) - Armor (1). - Result 3 vs 1: Victory +2 (The wish effect activates).

The shot is perfect but something strange happens, at the last moment Hanya moves almost imperceptibly and the arrow grazes her and continues on its way. A groan is heard further on and the three heads turn toward Peek then toward the trees that line the mountain foothills. The trees begin to move. And suddenly a monstrous head appears: a gazzam!

But that is not all, other monstrosities appear. Ancient dragon-like creatures: there are about a dozen and their piercing cries burst the heroes’ ears.

Ikarnos: “Quick, to the mounts, let’s flee, they are too big and too numerous!”

□ The Flight - Conflict: - Horse, using the terrain, Hanya’s safe route (3) - Gazzams’ charge, fury, cries (3). - Result 3 vs 3: Victory +1

The heroes decide to flee through a route that goes up through the mountains, hoping the too-large monsters will not be able to follow. Looking back, they see a small dead dinosaur with Peek’s arrow in its eye. That explains their fury. Fortunately, they manage to escape but it was close, and now they must continue along a promontory in single file, watching their mounts’ steps.

Peek: “the witch seems to have told the truth. I just wanted to verify. You can once again thank me.”

Hanya: “Ikarnos, let us treat this primitive as she deserves and chain her. Death would be too noble for her.”

Ikarnos: “Enough. We must advance and we will talk about all of this tonight at the bivouac.”

And so our heroes cannot descend to the hills of the Dragon Pass and must continue along the mountains to the North in an icy silence.

Shortly before nightfall, the heroes stop to make camp. Tension is high. The meal is meager as well since they must make do with their reserves.

Jaridan: “if Peek tells the truth, the witch indeed granted our wishes.”

Peek: “It seems so. You should thank me Hanya, no?”

Hanya: “so Ikarnos can speak to Dragons? Yet some kind of Dragons attacked us!”

Ikarnos: “The Witch predicted I could one day speak to them but did not say when.”

Jaridan: “like me, the peace I long for will only come if I sacrifice my family for it. Is that truly worth it?”

Peek: “You are bound to this witch. And apparently her death did not undo the wishes. So do not hold me responsible for everything that happens. On that note, good night. I will take the last watch.”

Ikarnos: “We must stay united and tomorrow we will talk about the mission. We must not act as you do Peek. We are observers. We must find a plausible cover to cross these lands and reach Prax. We have the night to think.”

Now that night, Peek’s sleep was restless. Indeed, the Kill the Stranger spirit imposes that she not kill during a moon cycle, and by killing the young dinosaur, she broke the bond. The spirit visits her and embraces her soul. Peek is drenched in sweat and upon waking, the spirit is gone, it has regained its freedom.

At dawn, Ikarnos studies the maps. They could not descend south as he had hoped. He feels a slight pang in his heart because he would have liked to approach the Eye of the Dragon, a draconic city that might have revealed a bit more of his destiny, but they must pass north toward Dwarf Mine. The Lunars are not on bad terms with the people of Mostal but are not allies either. Yet the Empire has burned Elven forests, they could be grateful but these strange creatures seem interested in something else, perhaps it is an opportunity to learn a little more. Then they will need to reach the Aldachur road and travel in Orlanthi territory. They should learn more about the Vantatos and Tovtaros tribes to know whether to approach Aldachur from the south or the north. They will then be on the road to Pavis heading to Prax. For now, our heroes must therefore continue and negotiate passage through Dwarf Mine.

Dwarf Mine

Dwarf Mine (mountain access)



Who?  Meeting with the other

What?  Authority

Possible interpretations: Ikarnos attempts to assert his position as leader. A roll on how could give the condition of passage.

The heroes arrive at Dwarf Mine and request passage

The heroes continue to follow the mountain foothills. Impossible to descend to the plain from their position. They are on a kind of plateau and the cliffs are too high. According to the maps, they would even be walking on an enormous dwarven city. Strange people, who have lived underground in the mountains since the dawn of time. Small, stocky, strange, none of the characters have ever interacted with them. Our heroes discuss what they know or think they know about dwarves.

Peek: “their constructions are as you like them, in stone and immobile. For us they are fragile and resemble death, frozen. The great city of Pavis was partly built by Dwarves. That did not protect it however, because we nomads, more mobile, always find a way to destroy what is immobile just as water erodes the ground little by little.”

Jaridan: “they are different from us but it seems some merchants have already managed to trade with them, at least those at Dwarf Mine. They are materialists and there is always a way to negotiate with someone who loves gold.”

Hanya: “their constructions are certainly sturdy but they have no sense of aesthetics, they have not been touched by the grace of the Goddess. They may have helped build the Daughter’s Road but it is we Lunars who created the beauty and purpose of this road. They are therefore to peoples what a tool is to things.”

Ikarnos: “those are words full of wisdom Hanya but I wonder if they do not have a hidden purpose and I wonder if we could discover it during our passage. Keep your eyes and ears open but no unfortunate initiative, especially you Peek, they are probably thousands strong and we are only four. Besides, speaking of which, Peek I would like a word with you.”

Ikarnos and Peek go talk aside.

Hanya: “this is going to get ugly.”

Jaridan: “she is not bad at heart, she defends what she believes in and did it to help us in her own way. But what a character! I like her.”

Hanya: “pride can endanger the common cause and that is what worries me.”

Jaridan: “I think Ikarnos will know how to talk to her. He speaks little but I do not think it is by chance that Fazzur chose him for this expedition. Sometimes he scares me more than Peek I must confess. Without meaning any disrespect, we free men of Tarsh sometimes have trouble understanding your customs and ways. He carries the Emperor’s seal and according to rumors, Argenteus the new mask is very different from Ignifer.”

Hanya: “the Goddess has always chosen well. It is we men who are fallible. I have complete trust in the current Emperor despite the rumors. He announces unprecedented prosperity in the history of Glorantha.”

Jaridan: “May the Gods hear you...”

□ Ikarnos's attempt to assert authority over Peek - Conflict: - Protagonist: Peek - Peek's loyalty - Hard to impress - Antagonist: Ikarnos - Emperor's teaching (convince) - Make the third way triumph - Result: success +1

Ikarnos flatters Peek and acknowledges that she tried to do well in taking her own initiatives. He tells her about the differences within the group and in their ways of seeing things differently. He tells her they need to find a solution to survive.

Peek listens with her big ember eyes but ends up concluding in her usual way: "I listen to the voice in my heart Ikarnos and I know that despite everything you say, one day, that voice will save us all. And I do not need a witch to reveal myself to myself. We are still here and well alive, more alive than ever even. Do you truly believe I am crazy enough to endanger a mission that will bring me home to Prax! We are far from Peloria now and I do not intend to undermine your authority but I intend to keep my freedom of action because without freedom of movement, that is death, that is how we nomads are and that is how we triumph."

Deep down, she thinks of those Sable men who now parade with their riches acquired since their victory with the Lunars. She knows they were bought and that what they won they are losing elsewhere. As the daughter of a clan chieftain, she does not need that and she is a woman. She is not here by chance and she is very proud of standing up to this Lunar.

Ikarnos concludes: "then we will triumph or you will perish. E pluribus Unum."

The small party sets off on mountback following the plateau. After a day of travel, they spot in the distance a square fort surrounded by a wall that hugs the mountain completely.

Ikarnos: "there is what we are looking for. Let us advance cautiously."

Arrived at the base of the wall, they observe but see nothing. No movement, no living soul, no guards on the walls and no way to make contact. This does not bode well.

Ikarnos: "the problem is that this entrance is on the mountain. Access must be more open at the bottom of the cliff. Let us wait. Let us make a fire to be noticed. We are here in peace and it would be surprising if no one saw us."

So they keep vigil and wait. Upon waking, they suddenly find themselves surrounded by a dozen small creatures in heavy armor, armed with crossbows, bearded and suspicious. One of the dwarves approaches:

"You are on dwarven land, humans. What are you doing here? What do you want?"

Ikarnos: "We come as friends and we want to descend. We were attacked by Gazzams and had to go back up the mountain road."

The dwarf: "your story is strange because this is not a trade route." He seems suspicious. Perhaps he takes them for spies.

Ikarnos: "we come from Dunstop and are heading to Prax. We have been mandated by Fazzur. Here is his seal." And he hands the seal to the Dwarf.

The latter takes it and says: “wait, we will be back” and he leaves with the seal.

Hanya: “That’s clever, they are going to make a copy.”

Ikarnos: “I could not care less. Only our passage matters and what would the Dwarves do with Fazzur’s seal, nobody would take them seriously.”

A day later, the Dwarves return and hand the seal back to Ikarnos. “We will let you pass but on one condition, write a letter to your master so that your people stop digging the mountain next to the Slave Wall.”

He must be talking about Slave Wall, a city north of Tarsh known for its slave market and especially its salt mines worked by slaves. A way to occupy defeated barbarians, nomads, or political opponents.

Ikarnos hesitates, the Dwarves’ request carries heavy economic and strategic consequences. “That seems like a lot for a simple passage. Would you not prefer gold instead?”

□ Negotiation with the Dwarves - Conflict: - Find the path to the solution + the Dwarves’ venality - Position of strength - Result 2 vs 1: victory +2

The dwarves accept passage in exchange for gold. The objective is achieved but with a loss of gold.

The gates of the wall open and the group enters the fortress compound. The constructions are massive, surprisingly large for a people of such small stature. The dwarves do not speak among themselves. They advance in an organized manner and resemble ants. Nothing special is visible: openings, iron doors.. there is no plant element, everything is only metal and stone. The dwarves lead the players through a great opening and there before them is a platform. They invite them to mount it with their mounts. The platform is 10m by 10m and is large enough for the 4 heroes and their mounts.

A dwarf speaks into a pipe in a guttural language that none of the characters understand. Then he activates a lever and the platform begins to vibrate. The dwarf smiles. Peek grips her lance. Jaridan places his hand on her shoulder and whispers: “calm, friend.” The platform lurches and they begin to descend along the mountain through a tunnel with smooth walls lit by luminous globes. They cannot believe it. The descent is long and slow but they are reassured. The Dwarves are indeed leading them down to the plain!

Dwarf Mine (plain access)

Note: characteristic of Dwarf Mine: piece of the cosmic needle, Isidilian, individualist and open, search for artifacts

The platform stabilizes and they arrive at the bottom of the cliff inside a great hall. They leave the hall and are taken in hand by a group of heavily armed dwarves who lead them through various halls where they pass busy dwarves.. Groups carrying stones or pieces of metal, others “singing” with tools in hand. These look at them pass with a suspicious air but do not intervene.

Ikarnos asks one of the dwarves in the escort: “Do you understand our language, friend?”

The squad stops and one of the dwarves turns and says: "I have taken courses and I understand you. What do you want?"

Ikarnos replies: "we are indeed just passing through to go to Prax but would it not be possible to address a leader of your people to perhaps.. forge an alliance between our peoples?"

The dwarf reflects, stroking his beard, appearing to be deep in thought and they can see him moving his fingers as if counting something.

□ Will he accept the request? - Conflict: - Win-win link (Jaridan), rune of mastery (Ikarnos) - Fear of being punished for his initiative - Result: Victory +1

Jaridan says to the dwarf: "without mixing, there is no alloy."

Ikarnos's natural authority also seems to work and the dwarf accepts. He leads them to a room for guests. The furniture is stone and the dwarves take the mounts. Fta-ah is nervous and Peek refuses to see her mount taken away by the Dwarves.

Sensing trouble coming, Ikarnos declares: "the woman will follow her antelope to the stables and stay with her."

The dwarf widens his eyes: "as you wish."

Peek thus follows the Dwarves. The other three remain in the room and wait. For a long time, very long. They are served a sort of meal made of moss with a rather unappetizing taste. Meanwhile the mounts are taken to the dwarves' pony stables. Peek thus ends up with the beasts. She does not feel very comfortable locked in the mountain, she who is used to the open air of the Praxian plains, and she tries to reassure Fta-Ah. She too gets the dwarven stew but tolerates it a bit better than her companions, probably accustomed to nomad food.

After a night, someone comes to get Ikarnos, Jaridan, and Hanya. They are led through halls. Sometimes it is very hot. The dwarf guiding them answers that these are the Forges helping to repair the Machine that men broke. They strangely see some humans wearing an iron collar around their necks. They understand these are slaves. But apart from that they seem to move about freely performing their tasks: carriers for the most part.



Figure 17. Dwarf Mine

Before arriving before an immense door, the dwarves ask them to leave their weapons and they are then searched. Then they arrive in an immense hall, magnificently crafted. Every cm of rock is chiseled with geometric patterns, dwarven heads sculpted adorn the tops of columns, a warm yellow light radiates from the vault and floor-standing globes. Before them, there is a Dwarf sitting on a throne wearing a golden crown of almost blinding pure gold, his armor is equally so but in another metal. Around him Dwarves of all kinds, in armor but also in robes, and others in unidentifiable materials. The moment is solemn.

The heroes advance and Ikarnos sets the example by kneeling before the Dwarven monarch. “Your Majesty, thank you for receiving us” and awaits the response.



Figure 18. Isidilian

The king squints and gestures for them to rise. “I, Isidilian, King of the mine of the Needle mountains, welcome you with pleasure.”

He speaks Pelorian! And continues: “you are lunar from what I have been told. Do you know that the raising of the Red Moon was in the Grand Schema to repair the Machine? Haha.. I see from your faces that you did not know. Normal, you are so young, you have not known the wars of the Gods nor the wars of Empires, you only see a small piece of the Plan, you are like the rabbit in its burrow but you are part of the Plan. Fazzur your employer is part of the plan.”

Hanya steps forward: “Noble King Isidilian, you built the Daughter’s Road with us and soon other roads will be built, will you still be ours in the Grand Plan you speak of?”

The king replies: “That depends on you. Certain variables will push us to be so but others will not. How to say in your language? Let us say that if you commit certain acts or if you do not commit certain ones, then the paths will be different.”

Ikarnos: “indeed, you expressed the wish that the Lunars stop digging the mountain. I can report to my hierarchy but to decide we would like to understand.”

The King: “it is not slavery that poses a problem for us, although we think you use your recruits badly. They dig poorly and you punish them. We treat our slaves better: we maintain our tools.. but no matter, inquire Lunar and but know that we are not dupes of your plan over there.”

Ikarnos: "I will inform Fazzur and come back to you but I will be in Prax."

The King: "you can inform my companions of Pavis.. Ask Clousilex.. and speaking of Pavis, as I was telling you there is what you will not do like what happens in the mountain near the Slave Wall but also what you will do at Pavis. Some time ago, a man came and stole Dwarven weapons from us as well as a very precious bracelet. We tracked him in the Dragon Pass and learned from his clan that he had fled to Prax. Find him in Pavis, recover the weapons and the bracelet, bring them to us or leave them with Clousilex and we can forge ties."

Jaridan: "what is this man's name and how can we recognize him if he has changed his name O king?"

The king: "his name is Jaknar the Red, because of his red hair, he has the tattoos of Orlanth, that is all I can tell you and here is the type of weapon he stole from us."

He signals to another dwarf who arrives opening a stone casket and inside is a sort of metal tube connected to a stone stock, a hollow stock in which balls can be placed, topped with a sort of lever.

"Let us say it is an advanced sling that can kill in one shot. Only the people of Mostal has the right to use Mostal's tools! You have stolen too much from us in the past and the Plan is very clear on this, it is no longer permitted."

Jaridan: "so you no longer trade with men?"

The King: "we no longer manufacture weapons for men. In the coming war, we may perhaps provide warriors but as the Plan's variables are not all known, we do not yet know but we will be ready whatever the camp because it is our lot to be ready."

Ikarnos: "I thank you Isidilian the Wise and I will pass the message to Fazzur regarding the Slave Wall and once in Pavis, we will find the thief and recover your goods. You know well that we Lunars do not particularly hold the Orlanthis in our hearts either."

The audience ends, the heroes recover their weapons and are escorted by the Dwarves to the stables.

The heroes find Peek and are ready to leave: "they have ponies and sheep but that is all I saw. There are also human slaves who take care of the animals. I tried to talk to them but most seemed frightened."

□ Did Peek succeed in establishing contact with a slave? - Conflict: - Peek: be nice (1) - Slaves: fear of working badly (1), well treated (1), not the same language (1) - Result: Defeat: -1 so too scared to talk and moreover they did not understand anything Peek said.

The Dwarves lead the heroes before two immense steel doors with hallucinatory motifs. The door opens without noise which is a feat for a double door over 20m high! The light hurts their eyes. They advance, greeting and thanking the dwarves even though this passage was dearly paid for.

They find themselves at the bottom of the cliff at the beginning of a great plain. They look behind

them and see two immense massive statues 30m high framing the doors which are already closing. Helmeted statues, armed with lances and shields as gigantic as they are sublime.

Jaridan whispers: “they say these statues can animate to defend the entrance. Brrrr, I would not want to face such colossi in motion.”

First Sartarite Encounters

On the road to Aldachur

The group advances through a landscape alternating between flat terrain and small hills. The lands are arid with just grass and trees here and there. Perhaps the presence of the Dwarves has something to do with it, knowing the aversion these latter have for everything that is plant-based: Aldrya the goddess of plants and her people the Aldryami that men call Elves are their ancestral enemies after all. Jaridan is a bit nostalgic, he knows that if they continue north, he could reach the northern road and branch westward and thus reach his family. The witch’s prophecy haunts him and he knows he will not do it but what is more terrible is that perhaps he will never see them again. He decides to write them a long letter once at Aldachur. Ikarnos has decided to go south, to cross the River that runs through the kingdom of Sartar from north to south then follow one of its tributaries that according to his maps should lead them to the Aldachur plateau. Peek and Fta-Ah are happy to find the open air and gallop along filling their role as scouts. Hanya says nothing. Ikarnos watches the landscape. A few ancient stones marked by draconic symbols from the WFH catch his attention. He looks right and left where he might see traces of the Dragons, a subject that has preoccupied him since Elemenoria made her revelation about a destiny related to these creatures, but the landscape remains desperately empty.

This is not the case on the second day of travel. They begin to see fields and peasants working them. They also see livestock watched by armed shepherds. They pass far enough away to show they are only travelers and not a threat. Children come to spy on them. The region has been under the Empire for at least a generation and the Lunar presence is no surprise. One can even see from a distance in some villages on hillsides houses mixing the Heortic style and the Lunar style. And it is precisely while approaching a lunar-style house built on a small hill that they spot a columned domus surrounded by a group of about twenty men holding torches in broad daylight. They decide to continue their road but send Jaridan to find out what is going on.

Angry peasants

Jaridan arrives on the scene. “Greetings, I am traveling and I saw the torches, what is happening?”

A man steps forward: “We are going to make those monsters confess!” he says, pointing at the house.

“Monsters? Explain yourself, I am traveling with a warrior and a nomad who know how to fight, perhaps we could help you!” he says, noticing that the men seem more like farmers than armed thanes.

“My name is Irken and in that house lives Cai Delli and his wife. They came 5 years ago like so many others since the colonization, and since Harvar Ironfist invited and accepted them on our lands, supposedly to become powerful and prosperous!” He spits on the ground. “They brought the

vine and make wine. My brother Riken came to buy some. He was found butchered a few kilometers from here.”

Jaridan: “they killed him?”

Irken: “6 months ago another body was found in the leg and atrociously mutilated, they said it was beasts. I went to see his mother and curiously the young man did not live very far either. I am sure it is no coincidence. Just looking at them, they are strange. Always smiling, beautiful, they deceive everyone I am sure. The Circle does not want to intervene and they think it is wild beasts, perhaps werewolves but since the arrival of Jones Wulf, these have taken refuge much further east. We came so they would follow us and we could take them to see old Gartinor, a Grey Sage who can perform a divination and tell us the truth.”

Jaridan: “and they agreed?”

Irken: “they refuse, arguing that they only answer before lunar justice!, which means we would have to go see Harvar in Aldachur but it is far and our clan is not the best off to make such a request. In any case, the clan will not do it.”

He seems truly desperate.

Jaridan: “wait friend, I will go see my traveling friends and see if we can help you.”

Irken: “but how?”

Jaridan: “wait”

And he rides back to join the other three and explain the story.

Ikarnos: “and you would want me to represent lunar justice with Hanya, is that it?”

Jaridan: “it costs nothing to try, right? If we resolve this story, we will have won the respect of a clan, unless you are in favor of the strong method to subdue Sartar and its peoples, but I doubt it.”
Hanya: “let us go and may justice be served on this matter.”

The four heroes then ride up the hill under the astonished and suspicious gazes of the farmers.

Jaridan: “I am traveling with a lunar scholar and a guardian of the city of Jillaro. Lunar justice from Aldachur is too far but these two are able to speak to the man and woman locked in there.”

After some explanations and deliberation on the plan to follow, it is decided that Ikarnos, Hanya, Jaridan and Peek will attempt to enter the domus accompanied by Irken to speak with the hosts. The mounts will remain outside, which Peek accepts after obtaining Irken’s promise that the farmers will treat them well.

Cai and Visa Delli

Ikarnos knocks on the door: “I am Ikarnos of Raibanth and I wish to speak with Cai Delli the master of this place, myself and my companions. We come in peace to help prove your innocence.”

After a few moments, the door opens, an ephebe opens for them (undoubtedly a slave).

Ikarnos: “he also comes with us to defend against his accusations but the others remain outside, do not worry” and the ephebe guides them through the residence, along a cloister.. they spot beautiful servants here and there.

Curiously, from all these people they sense a sort of pride and no fear. They are led into a vast hall with benches and a table laden with food: grapes, roasted quail, heady wines. Standing there are a man and a very beautiful woman dressed in an elegant tunic and toga with jewelry for the woman.

The ephebe: “here are Cai Delli and his matron Visa Delli.”

He steps back. The two hosts finally smile: “so here are our saviors! and what is he doing here?”

He seems to have nothing but contempt for Irken.

Ikarnos replies: “he lost his brother in atrocious conditions, even innocent you could show compassion. I am Ikarnos of Raibanth and I carry Fazzur’s seal with me which makes me the legate of lunar justice in the absence of a proper tribunal. Your accusations are serious Irken. Leave us alone you others, I need to speak with Cai and his wife.”

Everyone leaves for the next room. Ikarnos sits, massages his temples and intends to use the lunar charm that allows him to reveal a hidden secret.

□ Reveal a secret - Wild day: full moon - Conflict: - reveal a secret - hide a secret (We assume they are hiding something (even though we have not yet decided if it was them or not the culprits) - Result 1 vs 1: defeat -2

Ikarnos discusses with Cai and Visa but sees in them only charming and well-educated hosts and sympathizes with their life in these boorish and violent lands, understanding they came here because they could not stay in Peloria but he thinks of a political exile as happens so often within the Empire. Cai and Visa ask him to clear their names and to reward him offer to let him stay the night with his companions.

Ikarnos brings the others back and announces he has probed their hearts and has no doubt about Cai and Visa’s innocence. He asks Irken to leave and stop bothering them. As proof of the trust he has in Cai and Visa, he even announces that he and his companions will stay the night and leave tomorrow for their journey.

The farmers grumble but Jaridan tells them they must find the real culprit and not stop at the first convenient one just to relieve his pain and he places his hand on young Irken’s shoulder with great compassion.

Cai and Visa take the mounts to their stables then lead them to two fine rooms in the house.

Dinner. Werewolves are discussed.

Chaos in the night

Bedtime. No living soul. A servant goes to Jaridan who rejects her because he thinks of his family. She goes to Ikarnos who does not reject her. The ephebe goes to Hanya who does not reject him either. Nobody goes to see Peek. Everyone sleeps except Peek who goes to the stable.

□ The smoke - Peek not concerned - Conflict: - no suspicion - quick and effective trap - Result 1 vs 2: failure -1

Jaridan realizes someone is trying to poison him, he gets up but collapses.

Peek going to the stable notices red eyes and discovers a statuette with wings a tail and horns resembling the devil Wakboth! The eyes glow and pulse. She returns to the rooms Hanya sleeps. Ikarnos too. Jaridan on the ground. Impossible to wake them!! She takes the weapons and hides everything at the stables then goes to see the other rooms.

□ Stealth - Conflict: - On guard, nomad - suspect nothing - Result 2 vs 1: Success +2



Figure 19. Cacodemon

She sees the occupants of the house: two servants, the ephebe, Cai and Visa performing a ritual with the statuette. They are naked. She sees their fangs and hears the name Cacodemon. She sees an hourglass and understands that when it ends it will be the end. She even understands the gas. She rushes to the rooms and drags her companions outside. They come back to life in the stables but that is the moment the ogres choose to attack them and rush upon them.

□ Omission of the various conflicts having allowed playing the combat

Peek kills Visa with her lance. Cai screams in rage!! The ephebe dodges and puts Hanya on the ground ready to bite. The servant cannot bite Ikarnos. Jaridan holds back the second servant.

Peek kills the ephebe! Jaridan and Ikarnos are surrounded by the remaining ogres.

Cai summons an infernal! Chaos falls upon the house.



Figure 20. Infernal

Peek isolates the servant. The other servant joins her father. The infernal appears! It is 5m tall, smelling of sulfur!!

Jaridan resists the sight of Chaos. The others have already seen Chaos (Lunars and nomad)

Cai and the other servant retreat. Ikarnos steps back. The other servant escapes from Jaridan. Fta is wounded.

The heroes flee, feeling outmatched. They see the infernal's head through the door.

The infernal does not leave the house. Our heroes gallop at full speed through the night illuminated by the full red Moon!

□ Is Hanya pregnant? Yes!!

□ Is Cai's daughter pregnant by Ikarnos? No

The group flees the Ogres and slows down when seeing the houses a bit further that should correspond to Irken's clan center. No time to look at the maps. The heroes slow down.

Jaridan: "thank you Peek, without you, we would all be dead devoured by those monsters! But by the way, what were they?"

Ikarnos replies: “When Yelm was killed by Orlanth and fell from the Sky, the world was covered in Darkness. To survive some men practiced cannibalism. They became Ogres. And to think I saw nothing!”

Peek: “You see Ikarnos, that I can be useful! We need to get Fta-Ah treated.”

Hanya: “we could also warn the village people and young Irken.”

Ikarnos reflects: “yes, they would probably be grateful and could heal the antelope. I would be curious to know for what reasons they left Peloria: were they about to be exposed? Probably. But apart from their taste for human flesh, they are impressive beings, cultivated, elegant and what strength! Perhaps we could make allies of them, no?”

Peek: “you saw what I saw, these people pact with the Devil. We nomads defeated Wakboth and you will see what we did to him when we reach Prax! Haha. I do not think the Devil can be an ally for anyone.”

Ikarnos: “you are probably right and thank you for saving us.”

But he thinks otherwise and intends to report it to Fazzur as soon as he can find an information network in AldaChur. Hanya also offers a thank you toward Peek.

After the Horror of the Night

The Apple Clan

After the horror of the night, the heroes enter the Sartarite village at dawn.

Day breaks. Villagers come out of their houses. The heroes advance on foot, leading their mounts. The people look at them perplexed. There are men, women, children. The children are taken inside. Some women go back home. Finally only men and women armed with lances remain.

Ikarnos speaks: “Good day brave people, we have news for your chief as well as for young Irken whom we have met. We ask for hospitality. One of our mounts is also wounded.”

A man steps forward and declares: “Greetings strangers, I am Jirudal, Irmir will take your mounts to the stables. Kalia, go get Sheena to look at the wounds of the... beast. You others follow me, I will ask the Circle to convene.”

Peek follows Fta-Ah and wants to make sure everything will go well. The others go to wait for the circle to convene. They gather in the great hall of the chief’s house while waiting for things to be organized. They are brought some food and milk. They recover from their emotions. They are also under the watch of a few armed men. Finally a discreet presence but they are not fooled. The decorations are still very Orlanthi in style. Lunar influence has not penetrated much in this clan.

Peek reassures Fta-Ah and chants a melody that calms the antelope a bit. A young woman in a white dress arrives with 2 servants. She has a basin of water and small bags with her. “Hello, nasty wound, the poor beast looks tired too.”

Peek: “hello, you must be Sheena, I am Peek-ee-Peek daughter of a chieftain, from Prax and here is Fta-Ah, she was wounded by Ogres. We had to flee and galloped through most of the night. She is

exhausted but will recover. Do you know the Healing Spirits?”

Sheena smiles: “no, but the goddess Chalana Arroy will provide, trust me.”

The priestess gets to work and applies ointments to Fta-Ah’s wound while murmuring prayers. Her hands seem wreathed in light.

Sheena turns to Peek and announces: “she will be fully healed after a week of rest. You will thus have to stay here.”

Peek thanks her warmly and is then led to the Hall where she rejoins her companions. She announces they will have to stay a week here for Fta-Ah to recover. They barely have time to react when things move around them, 7 people arrive and seat themselves around the great table located higher up in the Hall. Villagers stream in. Finally, Irken arrives looking distraught. Silence falls.

A burly man with a square face speaks: “I, Jarlan, Chief of the Apple Clan declare this session of the Circle open. Step forward strangers!”

The heroes step forward and introduce themselves, then present the facts. The people listen horrified.

Jarlan declares: “you killed 3 out of 5 and the infamous Cai is thus safe along with that monstrosity. Hmm, we must go finish the job and reclaim the lands. Will you be with us?”

Ikarnos: “We thank you Jarlan, and you can count on us. In any case our antelope must rest a week before we can leave. We will help you and leave right after.”

A man with a gaunt face and wearing a beard speaks: “if these ogres came here it is because there may be something in our lands that attracted them. We must find the cause.”

“And eradicate it!” declares a vigorous fellow wearing a Bull helmet while casting a dark look at the heroes.

“Calm down Brontos, they have proved they fought and we will verify.”

Brontos: “that thing in the Sky has revived the Chaos and you know it well. I will fight and We will prevail.”

Other people in the crowd repeat “I will fight and We will prevail.”

Jarlan: “let us not fan the flames my friends. I order a party of 20 thanes accompanied by the strangers to go see Cai’s domain and as Pizidan suggested, we must search the surroundings. I have spoken.”

Irken steps forward: “I request permission to accompany them and you, Jarlan, you should have listened to me! You all should have listened to me!”

A woman of the circle speaks: “even the lunar saw nothing, these ogres have become masters in the art of concealment. Let us count ourselves fortunate that the number of victims was not greater for our clan.”

The council ends and the expedition prepares. On foot. It will take 4 hours of walking to get back

there.

Return to the Delli villa

Finally, the group is a bit larger. There are indeed the 20 thanes but young people have joined, so Irken: about ten in total, some of whom were already there with their torches.” They arrive before the great residence. Silence reigns. Despite the sunny weather, anguish is clearly present in the assembly. The party surrounds the residence then a small group including the heroes enters through the great door. Bloodstains are visible where the combat took place but there are no more bodies. According to Peek, 3 horses are missing from the stables.

“They must have fled.”

They go around the house. No more trace of the statue. The furniture is still there. Jaridan notices the ventilation system that put them to sleep. There is a chest but it is empty. They even go down to a cellar and discover a large stone table, covered with dried blood traces in the grooves. The table seems ideal for holding a body. Everyone shudders. They see travel goods in a corner. They understand the Ogres mainly killed travelers. They also see small-sized goods. They killed Dwarves too! Jaridan searches and finds a hexagonal medallion.

“Should we not bring it back to the Dwarven King?”

Ikarnos reflects: “let us keep it and we will return it to his ClouSilex brothers once in Pavis.”

But one of the armed thanes stops him: “What are you doing stranger? This object now belongs to our clan.”

□ Succeed in keeping the medallion - Conflict: - Jaridan: negotiation (1) - Thane: legitimate (1) - Result 1 vs 1: Defeat at -1

The thane thus recovers the medallion. The group returns outside and is divided: what to do with the house? Some want to burn it, others find it a shame. The house is solid.

Ikarnos reminds: “that may not be the priority right now. If they fled on horseback, what can we do? They must already be far away now and we are on foot. Perhaps we should search the surroundings to look for what your Grey Sage advised?”

The search is organized. The Orlanthis adopt the Air method. They proceed by making a sort of snail representing the Air rune which is a rather effective way to search the surroundings. The Lunars use more the grid method and the Dara Happans use a solar method by sending groups in all directions (rays).

The vineyard search

✱ The ogres released snakes in their flight to slow them down. This is an opportunity to learn what snakes Glorantha has.

The heroes advance with the Orlanthis through the tall vines of the domain when suddenly the first cry reveals the danger. Orlanthis exclaim: “snakes!!” Dozens of snakes infest the vineyard.

Each player will face the snakes. We will see through a roll how many, what the impact of the attack was on the Orlanthis.

Fate: -1

□ Snake Attack - Conflict: - The sting-snakes: flash attack (1), swift (1), cunning (1) - Ikarnos: nothing (0) - Hanya: movement (1), safe route (1) - Peek: nomad (1), death lance (1), swift (1) - Jaridan: earth rune (1), in reserve at the time of attack (1) - Results: - Ikarnos (4 vs 1): Defeat -2 - Hanya (3 vs 2): Victory +2 - Peek (3 vs 3): Victory +1 - Jaridan (3 vs 2): Defeat -1

Ikarnos is bitten and the venom seeps into his veins. Peek manages to extricate herself from the danger zone. Hanya cuts down a few snakes and escapes too. Jaridan dodges but is not out of danger.

□ Snake Attack - Conflict: - The sting-snakes: flash attack (1), swift (1), cunning (1) - Jaridan: earth rune (1), Peek reinforcing with her bow (1), snakes dispersing to attack the Sartarites (1) - Result 3 vs 3: Defeat -2

Jaridan manages to extricate himself from the vines but a snake bit him too. He rejoins the others. There are enormously many wounded among the Orlanthis. Some are still lying in the vineyard. A decision must be made. A man steps forward and declares: I can burn the vineyard by Yelmalio.

Brontos the Storm Bull declares: "you will burn our men, fool!"

The man: "They are already doomed."

Peek proposes: "let us give them a dignified death without suffering."

And she nocks her bow awaiting the green light from the Orlanthis. The moment is heavy. The arrow flies followed by others launched by the still valiant Orlanthis. The men are killed. Then they see the Yelmalite raise his hands against each other and form a circle, they see the air thicken between his hands forming a sort of lens, the sun begins to heat and a ray shoots from his hands then another and another, setting fire to the vineyard which ignites burning the snakes as well as the few deceased Orlanthis.

Plot twist!

And suddenly they realize a young Orlanthis is being strangled by a strange rainbow snake that is planting its fangs in him. Hanya approaches, and crosses eyes with the latter who tries to hypnotize her.

□ Hanya against the Rainbow Serpent - Conflict: - strong (1), hypnotize (1) - lunar fanaticism (1), axe(1), swift (1) - Result 2 vs 3: Victory +2 - there were several unrecorded escalations



Figure 21. Rainbow Serpent

The combat is epic, the serpent does not hypnotize Hanya and tries to flee but she catches up with it and must deal it several blows. Seeing itself attacked the serpent tries to bite her. Peek knows that Hanya is immune to arrows but does not want to take the risk given what happened with the Gazzams and for now the proud guardian of Jillaro seems to be managing. The Orlanthis do not dare shoot and nobody is nearby to intervene in close combat. Finally after several blows, the serpent collapses dead!

They must act quickly because there are many wounded. The unharmed must run to the village to get healers. The wounded will walk toward the village to save time as well. Brontos is already amputating some seriously wounded people, cauterizing with his great axe. It is horror and sadness among the group members.

Jaridan and Ikarnos are wounded. This could get worse if they do not intervene quickly. Hanya and Peek leave with five other Orlanthis to seek help.

□ Race against time - Conflict: - movement (1), nomad (1) - poison (1) - Result
2 vs 1: Victory +1

The group arrives in time and returns with healers on horseback. Peek chooses to follow on foot: she would rather die than ride a horse! In any case she is not a healer. The healers arrive. Herbs are burned, and with the smoke they draw out the venom. Prayers to Chalana Arroy are sent. Ikarnos sends his thoughts to Deezola one of the seven mothers, a healing goddess in the Lunar pantheon.

The poison is stopped.

Return to the village

✳ Plot twist! (Illusion and Truth)

The atmosphere is heavy and Orlanthis begin to accuse the Lunars of having hidden things from them, which is ridiculous since they themselves suffered from it but they argue that they may have pretended. They accuse them of being in cahoots with the Ogres.

- Plead innocence - Conflict: - Ikarnos's Authority (1), Jaridan's Diplomacy (1) - Clan prejudices (1) - Result 2 vs 3: Defeat -1

They are made to understand that they are no longer welcome and cannot stay. Ikarnos reminds them that their Antelope must remain at rest. They propose to leave her and come back in a week to retrieve her or otherwise leave at a walk and camp where they see fit to rest which would actually be better for everyone apparently. So it is in a heavy atmosphere that the heroes leave and explain the situation to Peek who does not fail to insult the Orlanthis, calling them cowards, fools but nobody responds: their choice seems already made and they mourn their dead. The heroes recover their mounts, are given some food and they leave at a walk, leading them by the bridle so as not to tire Fta-Ah. Peek suggests to Ikarnos to denounce the clan to the Dwarven king since they kept the medallion. But Ikarnos replies they must move on. Although healed, it does Jaridan and Ikarnos good to walk and in any case, they will not be able to stray too far to make camp.

Forced Camping in the Dragon Pass

Forced camping in the Dragon Pass

Peek demands that we find a quiet place to spend the week and that there is no question of advancing until her Antelope has recovered. The group agrees and they search for such a place: a place easy to defend, with a water source not too far and food for the beasts. For the men, they will hunt.

- Find a quiet place - Conflict: - Peek's Nomadism, Hanya's Safe Route, Jaridan's Travel Knowledge - Near the clan, unknown lands, accumulated fatigue - Result 3 vs 3: Defeat -1

The heroes are tired, they see the village smoke in the distance, the daylight is beginning to wane, and they advance into hostile lands. Peek and Hanya try to secure their march and spot signs that might indicate a path to a quiet place.

Peek spots bear tracks on the ground and the group decides to follow them with the aim of finding its den to shelter in and with a bit of luck, the den will be large enough and well-located to serve as their base for this week. It is decided that Ikarnos will stay with the mounts. Peek and Hanya thus follow the tracks.

- Spotted by the bear? - Conflict: - Scout - Smelling odors and intruders -

Result 1 vs 1: Defeat -1

They suddenly hear a terrible growl that makes their hair stand on end. Impossible to know exactly where it comes from, as if the entire forest were emitting this growl. It sounds like a bear's growl.

Hanya: "this growl is not natural. I doubt we are tracking a normal animal. Is it wise?"

Peek: "we need to know more and be ready to attack or to flee if necessary."

Hanya: "the beast seems to have spotted us."

They agree that they need a strategy.

Peek takes out a small leather pouch and whispers a few words: "go find the beast and show it to me."

She leans against a tree and her eyes roll back.

□ Call to the spirit of the beast - Conflict: - Peek, Spirit of the beast - "Bear" -
Result 2 vs 1: Victory +2



Figure 22. Odayla

A small smoke exits the pouch then mingles in the surrounding air. The spirit searches and finally finds the gigantic black-furred bear sniffing the air but the spirit has no scent and the spirit relays

the image to Peek who also sees the bear, as well as where it is located. Moreover the spirit senses something strange and a human aura overlaps the bear's aura in Peek's vision. This bear would also be a human. It is incomprehensible. Praxian traditions do not usually incarnate animals. But it is a fact. They know a little more about their prey now.

Hanya and Peek return to camp and in doing so feign a possible withdrawal to reassure the beast. Jaridan explains that there are men who venerate the hunting god Odayla and that apparently some can even transform into giant bears. The companions decide to leave it at that, since the man in question probably belongs to the clan they just left. They need to find another place but if they stay in the area, they could see this man to talk to him, hoping he will be in his human form.

Night falls and our heroes are forced to camp rough in the woods. They make a fire and organize watch shifts.

The night passes without incident. Apart from distant growls and wolf howls. Morale is not excellent but they have no choice. It is early morning and they have the day to find a viable shelter. They decide to move away by advancing slowly so as not to tire Fta-Ah.

The apple orchard

The heroes come upon a magnificent and immense orchard filled with beautiful apple trees bearing juicy apples. There is even a stream meandering through the orchard. The spot is idyllic and ideal. The heroes stop. They eat apples without suspecting that this orchard is the clan's sacred orchard and that the apples are protected and must be consecrated by a priestess before they can be consumed.

□ Resist the power of apples - Conflict: - Ikarnos: 1 vs 2 → defeat -2 - Hanya: 1 vs 2 → defeat -2 - Jaridan: 1 vs 2 → defeat -1 - Peek: 1 vs 2 → defeat -2

Ikarnos and Hanya give their horses apples. Peek tastes one before giving some to Fta-Ah. As for Jaridan, as he was about to consume one, he sees Ikarnos and Hanya's horses collapse, drooling at the mouth! As for Peek, drool comes from her mouth and she feels truly unwell and weak.

Jaridan: "wait the clan was called the Apple Clan, their apples are probably protected against animals in the first place and there is something to repel apple thieves as well."

The air heavy, he declares: "the two horses are dead."

Hanya is devastated at having lost her thoroughbred from Sylila.

Peek sighs: "fortunately my Fta-Ah is safe that is what matters, we must leave here. I will recover, do not worry."

The heroes must still continue but this time they have distributed the belongings on the back of the only remaining horse. Fta-Ah is too weak to carry anything.

Ikarnos: "we will be able to buy horses at AldaChur, if we get there."

Crossing the stream

The group follows upstream the stream that flowed through the orchard, deciding to get as far away as possible from the clan's lands. Progress is slow.

Hanya: "As if they did not already have it in for us, they will not love us when they discover the two dead horses in their orchard.. With a bit of luck, it will pollute their orchard." she says sarcastically.

Jaridan: "that is why we must get away, especially if they have with them an adept of Odayla capable of transforming into a bear. Let us hope the carcasses are quickly found and removed from the orchard before they pollute this place which in my opinion is sacred to them."

They thus venture deeper and deeper and follow the stream which widens, bounding from rock to rock in a hilly landscape of smooth grass and stones. In the distance to the east, they see the ridge of the cliff behind which they know AldaChur lies on the plateau, their destination and perhaps a bit of rest, they hope.

Suddenly Peek raises her hand and points to a promontory a bit higher on the other side of the stream. "That could make a shelter, what do you think?" Ikarnos: "let us go see."

Ikarnos, Peek and Jaridan cross, but when Hanya crosses, the water begins to bubble. "Haaa what is happening?"

The others turn around. Hanya draws her kopi and looks around her. A waterspout erupts and tries to wrap around her legs to throw her against a rock!!

□ Hanya against the Potamid - Conflict: - movement - surprise, powerful water force, anger against chaos - Result 1 vs 3: Defeat -1

Hanya is hurled against a rock. A female creature rises from a basin a bit further downstream and lets out a terrible chant. Her movements are graceful and her hands make increasingly rapid circles, which attracts all the pieces of wood floating in the torrent then she sends them at Hanya!

□ Hanya against the Potamid with Peek's help - Conflict: - speed to regain land, protect herself from water with her axe, Peek's help trying to calm the nymph - floating wood attack, powerful water, anger against chaos - Result 3 vs 3: Defeat -1

The creature sends a current to try to drown Hanya but she manages to avoid it and gets out of the water exhausted but safe. The creature looks at the group with her big eyes. She does not understand. It seems the spirits contained in Peek's fetishes have calmed her.



Figure 23. Potamid

Peek brings her fingers to her temples and receives the creature's message through the spirits returning to her fetishes. It is not really a language. It is between dream and thought with images and sensations.

Peek feels water around her, then sees Hanya differently from what she is, dark, dirty, defiled and the defilement pollutes the waters in the form of barbed filaments that hurt.

Peek sees Ikarnos, Jaridan in the form of sand and pebbles while the mounts appear as walking plants then she sees or understands that she herself is in the form of almost liquid gas.

The creature makes movements and the waters clear again. The vision stops and the creature departs, diving into the torrent. She has disappeared.

The group gathers to see how Hanya is doing and after a moment of respite,

Peek recounts what she saw: "It was an embodied spirit guarding this torrent no doubt and she saw you as an enemy who would defile her Hanya. It is madness... unless she is hiding something from us."

Hanya: "I do not understand either."

Suddenly she places her hand on her belly. Jaridan notices the gesture and Hanya notices his gaze and suddenly she freezes because she just understood and crouches down: "ohh nooo!"

The others ask her: “what is it Hanya?”

She stands up proudly: “it is possible that life is in me but this life is chaotic. I am probably pregnant with Cai’s son!”

Armed with this revelation, the atmosphere is strange. Ikarnos imagines that Cai’s daughter may also be pregnant by him and that somewhere he will have a little ogre offspring. He reassures Hanya telling her there is no reason her child should be as monstrous as those they have seen if she is not given access to her people’s bloody rites but the subject is uncertain. They agree they will need to inquire with sages on the subject.

Hanya is morose. Peek takes care of Fta. Jaridan secures the camp, accustomed to traveling itinerantly when trading from clan to clan. They organize night watches because they are still impressed by these lands containing so many unknown wonders. But nothing happens and they manage to rest at last which they had not really done since their arrival in the region and their encounter with the ogres then the clan.

The next day they decide to explore the surroundings a bit to familiarize themselves with their immediate environment while remaining cautious because their stop must be temporary and they must not deviate from their objective. So they have quite a bit of time to themselves.

The group rests

Peek goes to find Ikarnos: “we are going to have a problem with Hanya. What she carries in her could corrupt her permanently and moreover you know very well that if we run into Storm Bulls and there are many in Prax, they will immediately see what she is and we will be massacred without quarter. I do not like this at all.”

Ikarnos: “out of the question to separate from Hanya. Unfortunately you are right, lunar magic does not allow separation but only inclusion. For example when the moon separated from the earth it was to integrate something greater, the sky. We do not destroy, we build. We sacrifice things for greater ones. I know that you nomads have always fought the Devil and chaos, perhaps you have rituals to heal these contaminations of chaos. But I will not accept that the solution be violent, hear me well.”

Peek: “you do not realize what awaits us” and she turns on her heel.

That evening Jaridan tells us about his family, his wife, his children, grown now. He asks us to visit his clan in case he dies to tell them why he left and that he never abandoned them.

Hanya is locked in her silence and seems to be digesting the news of her pregnancy.

The group finally finds its bearings in these unknown lands and allows itself a few days of rest to recover from their wounds and fatigue.

Ikarnos writes a coded letter to Fazzur

Coded letter for Fazzur

- “Pharandros: ambitious and enforces lunar law

- Inquire about Imex Rapiis one of his advisors who may have wanted to manipulate the young King but does not seem to succeed as much as he would like.
- Presence of exiles east of Bagnot: were attacked and prevailed but did not take the time to evaluate forces, passing rather discreetly through the lines.
- The witch Elemenoria is dead
- Had to pay for passage with the Dwarves of Dwarf Mine.
- Isidilian their King wants us to stop digging the mountain on the Slave Wall side.
- He told me to pass along the message and that we know why.
- Isidilian wants us to recover 1 Dwarven artifact for him from an Orlanthi thief.
- It is a Dwarven weapon: a deadly sort of sling.
- The Dwarves could provide troops in the future but have not decided.
- They no longer sell their objects.
- The Dwarves have human slaves whom they treat “well”
- Presence of ogres in an Orlanthi community the Apple Clan. Decimated almost the whole family but a man and his daughter remain. The man is named Cai Belli. They came from Peloria but may return there.
- Do not eat the apples of the Apple Clan without their permission.
- An adept of Odayla transforming into a bear lives in the clan’s lands.
- An embodied water spirit protects the stream upstream of the torrent that passes through the Apple Clan’s orchard.
- The Apple Clan does not seem particularly open to the Lunar Pax without being hostile either.
- Did not have time to stay longer to detect possible rebel groups.”

Ikarnos does not conclude because he knows he will probably have other things to write before their arrival at AldaChur and to date the document. He reflects for a moment wondering whether he should really pass everything along. The Goddess’s mask told him to help Fazzur but he knows this means he must also spy on him somewhat and therefore must not give information that could through the strange combinations of destiny harm the Emperor. In particular, he omits the prophecies and the fact that Hanya carries an ogre offspring in her womb.

The week passes without major incident. Ikarnos asked the hunters not to stray too far to avoid being detected because according to Jaridan, the clan may search for them regarding the dead horses in the orchard, even if in his opinion, they will content themselves with this mishap which should please them well. The heroes train: Jaridan with the staff, Peek with lance or bow, Hanya with her axe. Jaridan and Ikarnos discuss routes and maps. Libations are also made to their respective Gods. But one evening, during dinner, Hanya declares the meat is overcooked!

□ Does Peek see the pointed tooth that has begun to appear? - Conflict: - Peek has good eyesight - Hanya is too disturbed to oppose anything - Result 2 vs 1: Defeat -1

Peek does not notice that one of Hanya's incisors has strangely lengthened while she is eating.

□ Does Ikarnos see the pointed tooth that has begun to appear? - Conflict: - Observer, Sense a secret - Hanya is too disturbed to oppose anything - Result 3 vs 1: Victory +2

Ikarnos discreetly notices Hanya's incisor but says nothing. The situation is more serious than it appears. Knowing Peek's aversion to Chaos, he decides to organize the group as best he can by separating them. He notices the tooth is only visible when she eats but Chaos is gaining on her. He finds a way to isolate himself and asks Jaridan about Hanya's child, whether among the Orlanthis there is a way to heal traces of Chaos. The latter reflects.

□ Does Jaridan know enough Orlanthis myths? - Conflict: - Knowledge of Heortian myths, aided by Ikarnos's find the 3rd way spell - Rare myth - Result 2 vs 1: Defeat -1

Ikarnos attempts to apply the techniques of the *Diplomatica Scriptoriae* and in particular the magical writings on how to find the 3rd way but this does not help Jaridan recover in his memory whether he knows a Heortian myth or otherwise that could heal Hanya.

Plot twist!

Suddenly in the middle of the night, Hanya is seized by stomach pains. She vomits blood. Her eyes are red with blood, her 2 incisors are now clearly visible. She craves raw flesh! This time, the evil can no longer be hidden.

□ Does Hanya resist the call of her offspring? - Conflict: - Guardian of Jillaro (they are taught resistance and endurance) - Mark of Chaos - Result 1 vs 1: Victory +1

Hanya resists and her fangs disappear.

Peek holds her lance pointed at her and declares: "I cannot kill you with arrows but I can do it with my lance!"

The conflict seems inevitable.

□ Jaridan tries to calm Peek - Conflict: - Shout in a clear voice, convince - Chaos, strong opinions - Result 2 vs 2: Victory +1

Jaridan manages to convince her that it would not be honorable to kill one of his companions. But Peek declares it goes against the teachings of Waha to travel with a chaotic creature. Jaridan proposes to split the group in two. She would leave with him and Fta ahead. Ikarnos and Hanya could meet them at AldaChur. He gives them 60 days to resolve Hanya's problem after which they would consider the Prax exploration mission for Fazzur complete. He also declares that every day at noon, he would go to the temple of Yelmalion and they could meet there. May the Gods protect them.

Then with authority, he takes Peek aside and prepares the departure in the middle of the night. The group separates to avoid killing each other. Ikarnos is worried. Without mounts, on foot, in territory hostile to the Empire this will not be simple but he may have a plan. The ogres fascinated him and in the end if Hanya returned to Dunstop to serve as an emissary for the ogres and make the latter allies for the Empire, what formidable allies they would be! After all, Broos are found in the ranks of the Empire, so why not Ogres and Hanya could have a role to play there.

The Cliff Road (Peek & Jaridan)

Continuation of Peek & Jaridan's adventures

On the road to AldaChur

Jaridan and Peek advance cautiously during the rest of the night, on guard against dangers around them and Jaridan senses the fury of the proud nomad.

At dawn, they stop for breakfast and Peek declares: "why didn't you let me kill her?"

Jaridan shrugs: "who says you would have managed. Ikarnos would have defended her."

Peek: "and you?"

Jaridan: "I did not want to be among those who kill each other. I long too much for peace for that."

Peek: "against chaos, there is never peace!"

Jaridan: "perhaps we will find a way to heal her. In any case, that is what I will seek in AldaChur, there are temples there and sages, perhaps they will know."

Peek: "and if they come back and we have no solution?"

Jaridan: "I would not travel with an ogre. I would tell Ikarnos the mission ends there for me and I suppose you should do the same."

He observes her: "disappointed, eh? Me too, you know, if I accepted it is also to defend the cause of peace and you?"

Peek: “the Sable tribe is strong because allied with the Lunars but I distrust them. I fear they weaken us in reality. I wanted to find something to turn the tables but instead I have even more suspicion toward them. Well, we shall see. You might find your family soon.”

He darkens: “if that is the case, I would be a happy man to see my kin again but so unhappy because according to the Witch, I would never see peace arrive.”

They rest a bit and after some debriefing on the route to take through the valley separating the two cliffs of the Dwarf Marches, they resume the road. “I am glad your antelope is fully recovered in any case.”

The journey passes without incident. A few encounters with Orlanthis. Jaridan teaches Peek that the inhabitants of the Dragon Pass mainly venerate Orlanth for men and Ernalda for women. Orlanth is at war with the Red Moon and the Lunars have even forbidden openly practicing his cult. They use it to quell any rebellion, also taking the opportunity to procure slaves on the pretext of illegal cult, and the clan chiefs are so bewildered that they convert to the Seven Mothers or Yelmadio like Duke Harald of AldaChur. It is clever. They sow discord among the clans and only have to collect the points. Peek realizes they did a bit of the same in the end in Prax without the prohibition aspect but this aspect of the Empire does not please her. She thanks Jaridan for opening her eyes. Finally, they arrive before the great cliffs that lead to the plateau of the eastern lands on which the city of Aldachur lies further on, and Jaridan realizes it will be tough or even impossible to pass. Usually he takes the north by the main road but they are far from it. The Orlanthis told him of a road to the south however.

□ How to pass? - Conflict: - Jaridan: information from encountered Orlanthis, cartography + Peek: orienteering - little frequented, arid lands at the foot of the cliff, they got lost - Result 3 vs 3: Victory +2

They finally find traces of a trail that looks relatively frequented then with other clues, they reach to the south a wider road that seems to lead toward the cliff. And indeed they see before them a village and above it a road that winds along the cliff! They found it.

The village at the foot of the AldaChur high plateau cliff

Jaridan and Peek thus advance at a walk toward the village entrance forming a semicircle pressed against the cliff and surrounded by wooden ramparts. Two guards armed with lance and shield approach them. Jaridan addresses them: “Greetings! My name is Jaridan and I am a merchant. The nomad is with me as well and we come in peace. We are going to AldaChur and wish to take the cliff road.”

One of the guards replies: “You are welcome and under the law of Orlanthis hospitality.”

He seems to be watching for a reaction from the heroes. “We will accompany you to the Hall of our chief Sigmar where you will be able to dine and tell him of your journey. Follow me.”

Jaridan signals Peek to dismount and continue on foot through the village, leading their mounts by the bridle. They advance under the gaze of the villagers who all have rather fierce looks. Peek meets their gazes. These people please her because she finds again a bit of the scent of the wild lands of the Wastes. The Hall is the largest building in the village. The mounts are taken to the

stables and Peek makes sure Fta-ah is well treated. Many children come to see the antelope. The heroes enter the Hall and take some time to adjust to the dimness. It is mealtime and they are invited to a table where other men sit. The atmosphere is warm. At their table, they meet Jakran, one of the clan's warriors. He seems rather gruff but is curious to know these strange travelers, no doubt to know whether he should consider them a threat or not. Jaridan plays along and bonds a bit with the man. He explains subtly that he is going to Pavis to trade and that he managed to find a Nomad guide who had been recruited by the Lunars and is very happy to be returning home. The meal ends. Men and women share local problems then Jaridan and Peek are invited to present themselves to chief Sigmar who is seated a bit higher next to his wife, a woman of mature age, generously proportioned, bearing tattoos of the Earth rune, thus displaying her devotion to Ernalda the Great Goddess of the Earth.

Jaridan re-explains the situation and Sigmar replies: "you are welcome but do not linger in AldaChur it has become a viper's nest since Harald switched sides to pact with the Empire. You, the Nomad, what do you think of the Empire? Are you not allied with them in Prax?" Silence falls in the hall.

Jaridan prepares to answer for Peek but Sigmar signals him to stop: "let the Nomad answer."

□ Sigmar's personality: resources & relations. He seeks allies in his struggle against the Empire (medium) because he knows the clan is weak and would like to strengthen the clan's resources (objective)

□ Peek responds to Sigmar - Conflict: - Defend the Tribe, Contempt for sedentaries - Hatred of the Lunars - Result 2 vs 1: Defeat -3!

Peek true to herself looks at the assembled men and women with a rather contemptuous gaze. She does not seek to apologize for the Sables' alliance with the Lunars and explains that as a clan chief he should understand that a tribe does everything to defend itself and that they were thus able to defeat all their Nomad enemies and become the most powerful tribe of Prax.

Unfortunately this is totally counterproductive because with such arguments, it justifies the opportunistic behavior of Harvar Ironfist who became Duke of AldaChur by allying with the Lunars, dividing the tribes of the Confederation and even going so far as to abandon Orlanth and convert to Yelmadio.

Sigmar replies: "that is indeed what I thought. In that case you will easily understand that you cannot take the road of Orlanth, but go back north, you will find a fine road, often frequented by your friends. I will not insult you by attacking since you are under the law of Orlanthi hospitality but now that you are sated, you may remount your horses because you have road to make." And with that, he stands. The verdict is final!

Peek and Jaridan leave, casting an eye at the winding road that snakes along the cliff. They see young tattooed men practicing the Orlanthi sky-surfing. The marvel is impressive, they launch themselves along the cliff and dive into the void carried by the winds. They understand these young men are taunting them out of bravado but see no other way. The chief has spoken.



Figure 24. The cliff village

Ikarnos & Hanya's Misfortunes

Continuation of Ikarnos & Hanya's adventures

An alliance with the Ogres, why not?

Hanya slept until quite late. She wakes up. Ikarnos tells her: "Go hunt. Try to resist the blood but if you cannot, feed yourself. I thought while you were sleeping. If you do not feed the baby with blood, in my opinion it will take from you and this could cause your downfall." So Hanya goes hunting and returns with a rabbit for Ikarnos. She does not tell him that she has gorged on another rabbit raw. She sits down.

Ikarnos tells her: "you like me, were seduced by the Ogres of the domain. I do not think we were drugged or under a charm. I was fully conscious at that time. These creatures are intelligent, refined, and possess a magic that could be useful to the Goddess. I have decided if you agree to make this a strength rather than a weakness but this choice is yours. Perhaps Peek and Jaridan will find a way to heal you, but deep down, do you truly wish it?"

Hanya remains silent: "I am just afraid of no longer being myself."

Ikarnos: "I have with me a treatise on magic that speaks of the forgetting of names. I used it against the Tarshite exile, remember? I do not know what is happening but perhaps the mechanisms are similar."

□ Attempt to understand the phenomenon Hanya is experiencing - Conflict: - Forget the names - Chaotic transformation - Result 1 vs 1: Victory +1

Ikarnos understands that what is happening in Hanya is different. The Ogres' Chaos does not remove memories. It seems to simply infiltrate by creating an appetite for human flesh.

That is what he tells Hanya and adds: "the Goddess's enemies are not lacking. We could use them to feed our Ogre army. Cai and his family seemed quite human apart from that and I do not think they were pretending to be human. You will become different, that is all. Will you follow me in this project Hanya then?"

Hanya reflects and inspects her values but if this brings an advantage to the Goddess it could work. She knows the Goddess tamed Chaos like the Purple Bat for example and she ends up conceding it is a good idea. They then spend some time detailing their objective and the different stages or options to reach it.

- manage to find Cai and his surviving daughter.
- find another community of Ogres.
- approach a Lunar cult that knows Chaos
- discuss with the authorities: The Emperor or Fazzur? or both?
- once the choices are made, Ikarnos would return without Hanya to see Jaridan and Peek, lying to them to continue Fazzur's mission? (within 60 days)

They agree that returning to the Apple Clan is not a good idea, especially since Cai must be far away by now. They could head to the Serpent Pipe Hollow, a place reputed to be highly chaotic and located further north, but this could be excessively dangerous without guaranteeing they find Ogres there. The only lead they have is to start from the domain and search for traces of the Ogre. They know he left on horseback before releasing the snakes to protect their flight. They must follow the trail even if it dates back more than a week now. This is their only option. So here are the short-term steps: 1. return to the domain by bypassing the clan's lands 2. follow the trail.

If they meet Lunars, tell them they are looking for two fugitives. If they meet Orlanthis, pass themselves off as explorers whose group was separated. Cai and his daughter would have left on horseback to seek help because Hanya was wounded. But she was healed by the priestess Sheena of the Apple Clan to lend credibility to their story with a real name. And now they are looking for their companions. For the rest we will see later.

Ikarnos and Hanya slip through the lands without problem and arrive at the domain. The villa has been burned. What a waste, think Ikarnos and Hanya. They follow the escape route the Ogres seem to have taken.

Ikarnos and Hanya thus methodically follow the trail, discreetly questioning everyone they meet. Unfortunately nobody has seen the fugitive couple but this does not discourage Ikarnos who knows that patience always pays in intelligence work. Cai's options are probably limited too: either he returns to Tarsh, or he branches east to AldaChur, or he heads to the Serpent Pipe Hollow. They need to find the small clue that will allow them to deduce the direction they chose.

The Dwarf Marches

Now one day, as they follow the Dwarf Marches heading north, they spot a small group of four dwarves who seem to be discussing a bit further on. One of the dwarves is in a robe, two others look like soldiers, and another seems very old. The Dwarves spot them and the soldiers raise their crossbows in their direction. They approach with raised hands: "Peace my friends!" The Dwarves let them advance and finally the two groups face each other at 5m apart. The soldiers still suspicious, gripping their crossbows.



Figure 25. Mostali Group

The Dwarven robed one begins to speak: "Greetings men, I am Goundar of Dwarf Mine and we too, traverse the lands of men in peace."

The Dwarven one who seems old (almost of stone) holds a translucent sphere in his hands into which his gaze seems plunged.

"We are looking for two fugitives, a man and a woman. They have committed atrocious crimes and we must arrest them. Have you seen them?"

The Dwarven robed one turns to the older Dwarf. A crystalline sound emanates from the sphere and it seems to palpitate, changing color and on its surface appear multiple small lights flickering in an apparently random manner. The old man speaks in a guttural voice to the robed Dwarf who seems to darken. Time is suspended.

□ Resist the Dwarves' vision sphere - Conflict: - Ikarnos's enigmatic side, they are not guilty - Saw the Dwarven object, Rune pattern analyzer - Result 2 vs 2: setback

The robed Dwarf speaks: "Return the object you stole from us or die!"

The Dwarves' binary choices are always very clear.

Ikarnos speaks: "We stole nothing from you. What are you talking about?"

The Dwarves advance and ask them to let themselves be searched. They comply and the Dwarves of course find nothing. Ikarnos remembers the object found in Cai's residence.

He smiles: "Would it be a hexagonal medallion you are looking for?"

The Dwarf nods: "Where is it?"

Ikarnos: "Scratch my back, scratch yours, friend! I tell you where it is and you tell me if you saw a man and a woman traveling together."

The Dwarf: "And if I had not seen this man and woman, you would say nothing?"

Ikarnos and the robed Dwarf size each other up.

The old man clears his throat and the robed Dwarf begins to speak in another voice as if translating or as if the old Dwarf were speaking through him: "I, Grindaroum, saw you at Dwarf Mine, you spoke with Isidilian, if you know something, you must say it. You want to be our ally then prove it."

Ikarnos tells them about the fight against the Ogres and that the medallion is now in the hands of an Orlanthi clan, the Apple Clan. "You see Grindaroum, the Goddess is honest. So you can let us pass and continue tracking the two fleeing ogres."

The Dwarf speaks again: "I thank you Ikarnos of Raibanth" (*Ikarnos is impressed by his memory of names*). "These ogres have killed too many Dwarves and our expedition was tasked with finding the reason for all these disappearances. We know now but must recover the medallion. Now you know who the man is who took the medallion. If you lead us to him, then you will be able to connect to the far-seeing stone and attempt to find the two ogres. Do you accept to help us?"

A choice is thus offered to the protagonist: continue an investigation in these wild lands with not the slightest lead for the moment or try to obtain information through a magical means?

Ikarnos weighs the proposition and discusses in a low voice with Hanya: "it is risky given our relations with the clan but it is tempting, what do you think?"

Hanya: "it is terribly risky and you know the reasons Ikarnos. I do not know. Do you remember the face of the man who took the medallion?"

Ikarnos: "yes, I think I would recognize him but to approach we will need to use a stratagem."

Then he announces to the Dwarf: "I accept but we will have to be clever so that I can go back to see the clan and Hanya who accompanies me will not be able to come with me. If you agree to devise a

plan with me, I am your man and you will recover your medallion.”

The robed Dwarf replies: “Deal then.”

And so our two heroes find themselves embroiled in a mission with the Dwarves to recover one of their objects within the Apple Clan.

A Disappointing Alliance

Continuation of Ikarnos & Hanya's adventures

Return to the Apple Clan (Ikarnos, Hanya)

The Clan's Tula is quite close to where Hanya and Ikarnos met the Dwarves. Indeed, their laborious investigation has proven rather slow thus far because they did not want to let anything slip. This is rather a good thing because Hanya's presence given her condition could be a risk for our heroes.

Ikarnos thus proposes the following plan: “I could pass as your prisoner. We are not on good terms with the clan because they accused us of being behind the disturbances, which is absurd. Hanya will stay back in case things go wrong. And when I see the man either I will address him about the snakes, or I will address you about Isidilian. You will then know it is him. Only, how to succeed in stealing the object from him? I have no idea. We will see. The important thing is to be in the place. We also need to find a way to stay a bit on site to see people and have an opportunity. You could say that your companion who.. uh.. seems quite old needs rest before returning to Dwarf Mine.”

The Dwarf sketches what seems to be a smile: “a Dwarf never needs rest except when forging and working hard. They will never buy that.”

Ikarnos: “I have nothing better unfortunately.. they know nothing of your way of living and Gundaroum I assure you really looks like a tired old man so it could work... or else, we can say that I wounded him and you need to perform a Dwarven healing ritual so he can leave.”

Everyone reflects intensely but agrees on the plan. Ikarnos, the robed Dwarf, the old Dwarf, and one of the warriors will go to the clan. Hanya will stay with the last warrior, which does not reassure Ikarnos at all but well, risks must be taken.

Ikarnos's expedition

Our small group approaches the Tula. I agreed to be disarmed and to have my hands bound by iron bracelets, not without shivering because knowing the Dwarves' talent with metal, I know I would never be able to undo these bonds. But the game is worth the candle, I have known far worse situations at Raibanth when I scoured the city's underworld for the Emperor.

An endurance test

We finally meet the clan people and are brought to the village which reminded me of grim memories. The Dwarves speak with Jarlan and manage to deceive him quite easily I must say. Even old Pizidan is not so wise after all. The Dwarves even go beyond my expectations by offering, in exchange for their hospitality, to look at their weapons and any Dwarven-made objects to help them use or improve them. I realize that they probably did not need me after all to find their

medallion. I nevertheless scan the crowd for familiar faces. I see Sheena the priestess who healed Peek's antelope. Brontos the Storm Bull casts dark looks at me and I rejoice at having kept Hanya sheltered. This brute would have no doubt seen the Chaos in her and that would have unleashed his fury. I do not see young Irken who must be in the fields. I also see the man who burned the fields of Cai's domain. Probably the same who unleashed Yelm's fury on the domus.

□ Does Ikarnos see the thane who took their medallion?

This could be played as a yes/no roll or confrontation.

It may be useful to know a bit more about this medallion and this thane, I think.

The thane is named Korlan. Let us see his objectives? Korlan has a grudge against someone in the clan and aspires to use the Dwarven object to his advantage against this person.

But what is the medallion's property? It grants great strength to its owner. Useful for a thane who would want to prove his worth at the expense of another.

I think it is better to base it on a binary roll to know if he is present or not during the Dwarves' presentation. The man is absent, no doubt in his domain or on patrol.

While the Dwarves are installed in a hovel so they can "heal" their old "wounded," I am dragged to a post and tied to it, stripped of all my belongings.

I am confident in the encoding used in my writings for Fazzur, they should see nothing but fire, well I hope so. In any case, the danger lies elsewhere. Thirsty, hungry, tied to the post, the hours pass and I weaken. The Dwarven warrior accompanying the group stays nearby supposedly to watch me, which makes the Thanes laugh, but I know he is waiting for me to react if ever I saw the man we are looking for.

□ How will Ikarnos endure the ordeal and humiliation? - Conflict: - Self-sacrifice - Hungry, Thirsty, Physical bullying - Result 1 vs 3: setback

The hours pass. Children throw garbage in my face. I concentrate on my mission and my mind focuses on the Goddess's teachings who endured far worse: dismembered in the Age of the Gods she came back even stronger and triumphed over everything. I try to stay vigilant to spot the man and warn Nigmar in case but I eventually fall unconscious.

*** Plot twist!** The Dwarves could manage on their own and Korlan would have come to see them of his own accord and they would have recovered the medallion and fled (that would really be the last straw for Ikarnos) or

they would have freed Ikarnos (that would probably be too easy). Or the plot twist comes from elsewhere (Hanya? a Lunar visit? a clan attack? a divine message?...)

When there are too many options like this, it is a sign that a fate roll must be made. Result: relations. This leads to the Dwarves' track or Hanya's. An intervention by Hanya would be interesting I think but one must first know what is happening on her side.

At the camp with Hanya

I crave raw flesh. The ogre growing in my flesh reminds me regularly. I try not to look too much at the Dwarf because I might pounce on him and devour him. I politely refuse his Dwarven food that looks like a mushroom broth, using the excuse of needing to relieve myself to go hunt. I eat the animals raw, the heart still warm after having felled them with an arrow. I cannot stop thinking about Ikarnos's plan and wonder if this is what the Goddesses expect of me to save the Empire in danger.

***** Hanya's objective: wait at the rendezvous point but something must happen due to the plot twist. And Hanya has a big secret to hide.

As I devour a raw rabbit I felled with an arrow, I sense movement behind me. The Dwarf has followed me and seems to have understood something, holding his war hammer and letting out a cry as he attacks me.



Figure 26. Surprise

□ Hanya confrontation with the Mostali - Conflict: - War axe, Cleaving blow - Hammer, Hanya's delay to grab her great axe and stand up, well protected - Result 2 vs 3: setback

I must drop the rabbit, grab my axe and stand up, the Dwarf is already on me with his hammer. I manage to dodge. Can I flee? But he will warn the others. Must I continue the fight? I must fight thus and I wait to see what my opponent does.

□ Hanya confrontation with the Mostali - Conflict: - War Axe, Cleaving Blow, Mask of Terror - Hammer, Armor - Result 3 vs 2: victory +2

Fortunately the Dwarf has no particular tactic and simply attacks me again like the first time but this time I am ready and I invoke the Goddess's mask of terror to impress him, swinging my axe which wounds him badly. He collapses to his knees. *

I tell him: "This is not what you think. I do not want to kill you, know that. Stay here, rest." The Dwarf rolls his eyes and faints. I hesitate to kill him.

□ Hanya's resistance against evil - Conflict: - Guardian of Jillaro, more or less satiated with the rabbit - Mark of Chaos - Result 2 vs 1: victory +1

But I take the rabbit and finish it. This quells my thirst for flesh and I manage to control myself. It is better that the Dwarf survive in case things go badly and this could play in my favor. In any case he is incapacitated. Time is pressing, I must go to the village as discreetly as possible, retrieve Ikarnos and flee!

Return to the Apple Clan (Hanya)

I run through the hills, slipping through the undergrowth to be as discreet as possible. After more than a week in the lands of the Dragon Pass I was able to observe the lifestyle of its inhabitants and I adapt my movements accordingly to avoid meeting anyone and approach the village as closely as possible, attempting an approach from the north where I spotted hillsides that would give me a vantage point where I hope I could see Ikarnos and the Dwarves.

Hanya's objective: reach the village without incident to find Ikarnos

✱ Setback!

Damn geography, impossible to climb the hillside that easily, to the west shepherds and their flocks, to the east guards who seem to be watching something and before me, this rock that rises almost sheer. I must nonetheless climb and pass through here to reach the village on the other side. Or wait for nightfall. That is what I decide.

✱ Here the situation simply consisted of making a choice: face the warriors, try to pass through the pastures risking being spotted, attempt a perilous climb, or wait...

Apple Clan (Ikarnos)

When I wake up I see a small crowd in the square. Gundar informs me that a challenge has been issued and a combat will take place. I even get the impression he has a smile on his lips. There are starting to be quite a few people. Two men step forward in the middle of a circle drawn on the ground. I recognize the man who took our medallion.

I exclaim: "You there, remember the snakes! You know very well it was not me who summoned them!"

One of the guards strikes me with the butt of his lance to make me shut up. I take the blow, hoping the Dwarves understood the message. Besides, I must really be tired because I realize the bare-chested man is wearing the medallion around his neck. His opponent is also bare-chested, a big strong man full of scars. I recognize a tough fellow there. The old Sage begins chanting and recalls a law of honor and truth. Apparently a grievance opposes the two men and the man with the medallion has decided to challenge the other to bare hands. He is going to be massacred I think at first. Then the combat begins and suddenly doubt assails me. The man with the medallion takes his opponent's blows without flinching and when he starts to retaliate his blows seem of supernatural strength. Finally the big fellow collapses. The man with the medallion raises his arms in triumph.



Figure 27. The fight

The priestess Sheena and her acolytes carry him away to heal him. Then the village chief speaks with Gundar who brings the man with the medallion. I do not hear what they say but sometimes they look toward me. Finally they seem to reach an agreement.

A man comes with my belongings and gives them to the Dwarves. I regain a bit of hope. The man with the medallion returns the medallion to the Dwarves who in exchange give him my Vision of Darkness medallion. The village chief gives the Dwarves my Diplomatica Scriptoriae as well as my writing materials, not without having spit on the book before handing it over. That's it they are going to come free me but shock, I see them leave the village without me! I scream my rage at them but they disappear into the night that is falling.

✱ Here we played a little role-playing scene without confrontation or choice, just to prepare Hanya's intervention. The rules state that you are not obligated to make situation rolls if you already have a storyline in mind. Moreover in our case, the setback roll also seems obsolete given Ikarnos's limited objectives. The situation did not really allow Ikarnos to act with fate but it did allow the story to advance. On the other hand, we could make a plot twist roll but here we will consider that given the 1st plot twist has not yet been played, we move on to the next one to arrive there.

The night at the village (Hanya, Ikarnos)

Hanya waits for night to bypass the rock mass. She tries to be discreet to reach the village without incident.

The night is calm. It is the night of the wild day that follows the fire day and the Red Moon is full. On one hand, it could have Hanya spotted as she slips through the shadows but she also sees and especially in it a sign that the Goddess accompanies her fully.

Ikarnos dozes while remaining vigilant. His thoughts also turn to the Goddess but it is especially the wind that disturbs him. At the end of the square, the chief's hall is lively. Men are celebrating. He hears laughter and noise. How noisy these barbarians are! The gusts seem to participate in their joy. Should he be worried? The Sartarites have nothing to really hold against him and they would probably pay dearly if they killed him. At the same time they cowardly stripped him of his belongings which they gave to the Dwarf and the fighter. They will therefore certainly not release him.

He is thus lost in thought when suddenly a shadow passes nearby. Fear seizes him: have they come to assassinate him? But the moment he spots Hanya, hope is reborn. "Hanya, blessed be the Goddess!"

Hanya smiles: "Where are the Dwarves?"

Ikarnos: "Gone, traitors, they have my grimoire too."

Hanya cuts Ikarnos's bonds.

He briefly recounts what happened. "We must find the Dwarves and force them to honor their debt" says Ikarnos.

Hanya looks at him "And your other belongings?"

Ikarnos reflects and replies: "I will go get them right away."

Hanya shudders: "Are you sure?"

Ikarnos points at the hall which is now quiet, the men must be sleeping off their drink now. "If I do not come back, go find the Dwarves, recover the grimoire and force them to show you where Cai is with their strange stone! Then do not forget our plan. We will see each other in limbo perhaps."

Then he moves away toward the hall.

Recovery of the medallion and grimoire (Ikarnos)

Ikarnos uses all his stealth abilities to blend into the crowd as discreetly as possible.

□ Slip into the hall - Conflict: - blend into the crowd, stealth, scouting, all asleep - nearly naked, unknown place, numerous - Result 4 vs 3: victory +2

Ikarnos slips into the hall. Luckily, everyone seems asleep. He even managed to grab a shepherd's blanket at the entrance and in the dim light he would easily be taken for one of the many men who

came to witness the afternoon's challenge. Now he must find the man who stole his medallion. If his intuition is correct, the man must have it around his neck.

□ Find his medallion - Conflict: - imperial shadow, observation - find the man among the multitude - Result 2 vs 1: victory +2

Ikarnos takes a bit of time to find the man. The hall is large and he must adapt his movements to appear as natural as possible in case one of the men sees his silhouette. And suddenly he spots him and hears him because the latter is snoring, drunk on his victory. The medallion gleams at his neck and by luck, the man even has Ikarnos's dagger with him. Ikarnos seizes it, tempted to plunge it into the man's heart and let the poison kill him. He brings his dagger to the man and cuts the medallion's strap, which he recovers. Holding it in his hand and thinking of the Goddess's Mask, his vision sharpens and he sees through the shadows. The lying men now appear clearly. He shudders. What madness! There are perhaps fifty of them. It is time to flee. His legs wobble a bit but courage returns. He has no choice anyway. He grabs a tunic and sandals lying around to dress himself then rushes through one of the exits.

Ikarnos takes a deep breath upon leaving the hall and finding again the brilliant Red Moon in the sky. He then starts running in the direction the Dwarves took with the aim of finding Hanya as quickly as possible. The wind of the Dragon Pass whips his flesh and he prays that these Orlanthis winds are not spirits capable of alerting the Orlanthis.

Tracking the Dwarves (Hanya)

Hanya knows exactly where to go. The Dwarves will want to recover their warrior. Normally they should not find him since the latter is no longer at the rendezvous point but wounded several hundred paces from there, unless he was able to recover and reached the rendezvous point. Will they look for him? Will they abandon him? Will they use their strange magic? Impossible to say but in any case, they must have passed there necessarily and it is probable they will spend the night there.

□ Did the dwarves find their wounded companion? no.

Hanya has no trouble finding the initial rendezvous point and realizes there are only the robed Dwarf Gundar and the old Dwarf Gundaroum. The other warrior must be searching for him.

She advances holding her axe: "Greetings my builder friends!"

The Dwarves turn around, surprised, and reply: "where is our companion?"

Hanya smiles: "He is alive do not worry but it is not right to betray your oaths. I did not know the people of Mostal were capable of cheating."

Gundar replies angrily: "We betrayed no one! We have our medallion and that is all that matters. We recovered it without the help of your companion, we owe you nothing."

Hanya approaches, gracefully running her finger along the edge of her double-bladed axe: "And yet you stole his precious grimoire. Are these the practices of people who claim to be honest?"

Gundar looks at Gundaroum and replies in the old Dwarf's voice: "You may look in the stone if you return the iron Mostali to us."

Hanya: "That is better. And of course you return the grimoire?" She feels Dwarven avarice settling on their features.

"That is between him and us, we will not return it to you. And since he is not here, what do you decide?"

Hanya reflects. They are clever. She will only be able to see in the stone if she leads them to the wounded Dwarf and then there will be the other warrior and it will be a fierce fight if she wants to obtain the grimoire by force. Seeing no other alternative, she decides to lead them to the wounded Dwarf, leaving her cloak at the camp to warn Ikarnos in case he arrives and finds no one, hoping he will understand the sign.

On the road she decides to explain to the Dwarves what happened with the Ogres to justify why they are looking for them. She is carrying an ogre baby after all. Gundaroum seems to listen gravely to what this implies and confides in her: "Chaos is an external part to the machine and it cannot be repaired. But you humans do not seek to repair the machine, that is the error of your Goddess."

They finally find the wounded Dwarf, weakened but still alive. Gundaroum approaches him and places his hands on various parts of the Dwarf's body. The latter seems to feel better. He speaks in his language, pointing at Hanya. He does not seem to view her presence favorably. The Dwarves talk among themselves.

The Red Moon illuminates the scene as dawn peeks its nose. Gundaroum calls Hanya to his side and asks through Gundar to keep focusing on the Ogre she is looking for. The stone begins to glow then he asks if she is ready. She nods and the Dwarf invites her to place her hands on the stone. And there Hanya sees.

□ We must determine where Cai and his daughter went. Roll on list between: AldaChur, Pavis, Serpent Pipe Hollow, World's End. It is to Pavis that the Ogres are heading!

Hanya sees a desolate landscape that looks like a stone desert. There is almost no vegetation and there she sees Cai and his daughter riding. She tries to note all the details she can get from the scene, the position of the moon, the color of the sky. But the landscape is so desolate that she cannot make out a living soul. It is not Peloria that is certain. Another place in the Dragon Pass? She does not think so. Ikarnos would know, for he studied the maps. In any case, the two fugitives are safe and sound and they now have a means to find them. The stone fades and the vision disappears. Garun tells her that now is where their paths diverge. She hesitates. Is she capable of facing them? The valid warrior is absent and yet the old Dwarf offered her the vision. He must be confident in case of an attack from her or then, yes indeed, he trusts the other dwarf who has recovered his crossbow and is ready to shoot. Haha, blessed be the witch's gift!

She takes a deep breath and raises her axe: "you will now return my friend's belongings or someone here will die!"

□ Hanya confrontation with the Dwarves - Conflict: - red mask of terror - crossbow - Result: defeat -1

Garun signals the warrior, the bolt flies from the crossbow. A perfect killing shot and there, shock of the Dwarves discovering the shot goes straight into the old Dwarf's heart who collapses. Thank you Elemenoria!

Hanya says: "return my companion's belongings and we will be even."

The Dwarves are stunned and let her recover Ikarnos's writing materials containing his coded letters but above all his precious grimoire. She leaves the Dwarves still in shock and runs back to the rendezvous point, retrieves her cloak and heads toward the village hoping to find Ikarnos if he succeeded. If he failed, she will know because he will not come. She will have to honor her vow then, find Cai and create this new order of Ogres for the greatness of the Goddess.

Reunion (Ikarnos & Hanya)

Her heart beats a hundred miles an hour and suddenly she spots Ikarnos's silhouette, tottering, all weakened but finally free.

The two heroes join each other and embrace. Hanya explains everything that happened and Ikarnos declares: "decidedly our destiny pushes us resolutely toward Prax!"

Indeed, he recognized in Hanya's vision the landscapes of Prax. It is logical, the ogres will probably try a new life there. It remains to determine whether they will or will not rejoin Jaridan and Peek especially with their project in mind. But that, that will be the rest of the story to tell...

Glasswall (Jaridan & Peek)

Continuation of Peek & Jaridan's adventures

Arrival at Glasswall

Peek spends the next two days grumbling about the village chief's behavior at the foot of the cliff. This amuses Jaridan who makes a few trades with certain inhabitants they meet, bartering food and drink for weaving or Praxian necklaces as they encounter them. Within a day or two they should rejoin the main road coming from Tarsh leading to AldaChur. To think they could have taken that road and none of this would have happened.

Objective: at least reach the road if not AldaChur without incident.

The heroes should thus rejoin the Pavis road. Geographically speaking, here are the dangers they could encounter: chaos due to the proximity of the Serpent Pipe Hollow or arriving without incident at Glasswall, stronghold of the Princeros tribe.

Our two heroes finally rejoin the Pavis road, one of the royal roads from the time of King Sartar which, irony of all ironies, well served the lunar army for its incursions and invasions in the Dragon Pass. Advancing eastward, they enter an arid land made of crushed glass pieces on which nothing grows, then finally spot a circular fort with strange dark glass walls, Glasswall. Jaridan has

stayed there before and Peek passed through when she came to Tarsh last year. They thus head without incident toward the fort's entrance, happy to have arrived before nightfall because night in this region is often synonymous with chaos incursions that crawl near the Serpent Pipe Hollow, a bruise on the Earth located further north that vomits hordes of monstrosities at regular intervals. If one can speak of regularity with chaos! Night falling, they decide to take a room at the White Tree Inn. Times are quiet and the inn is not crowded. They settle in for a hearty dinner and listen to local news.



Figure 28. White Tree Tavern

A table not very far seems particularly agitated. The men speak among themselves in low voices. From their appearance, they are more warriors judging by the swords they carry at their sides. They notice glances toward them and suddenly one of the men stands up and comes to see them.

“Hello, strangers. I welcome you. May I offer you something to drink? We have excellent wine here at Glasswall. Yes yes, you will see.” He signals to the server, a big lout who brings them a large pitcher that he serves to our heroes as well as himself. “So travelers, what brings you to these distant lands?”

Jaridan replies: “We are going to AldaChur but actually we are heading to Pavis. As you can see I have with me a guide and a bodyguard for Prax. I intend to trade there. Do you know if the road is safe at the moment?”

The man replies: “Nothing is safe in this world with chaos, you know that well, friend but the danger is sometimes more from within than from without.” He has an enigmatic air.

Peek: "Is that a threat?"

The man: "Oh there friend, you are under Orlanthi protection, you risk nothing within these walls or on our lands if you behave well. You know and respect the virtues of Orlanth?"

Peek: "I only venerate Waha, Eiritha and the Spirits. Orlanth is a great spirit on your lands but he never set foot in Prax except since your defeat against the Empire which brought a good number of your like to Pavis. Is Orlanth so cowardly as to flee far from home rather than stay and fight with his people?"

Jaridan frowns. It is true that Peek is rather upset with the Orlanthis who prevented them from taking the cliff road. They would already be at AldaChur. But the man scratches his chin and says in a low voice: "There are battles one wins differently than head-on. And that, we learned since Harvar schemed, betrayed and brought AldaChur under his control."

Jaridan tempers: "you do not seem to appreciate Harvar. Would the Princeros be at odds with him?"

The man: "The Princeros? What Princeros? Those days are long gone when our ancestors faced the mountain giants. Now we are reduced to delivering our young men on the pretext of allegiance to the Duke of AldaChur." He withdraws into himself. "I should not bother you with this." He drinks his glass then pretends to leave.

Peek: "Stay and speak frankly. Are only nomads the ones who honor integrity in this world?"

The man sits back down and clears his throat: "Tomorrow at dawn, three of our young men will be taken to AldaChur to be judged there. We all know we will never see them again."

Jaridan: "And what crime did they commit to be treated this way?"

The man: "They merely dared to proclaim their devotion to Orlanth the Thunderer out of bravado. You seem like a mature enough man to know what youthful exuberance is. Unfortunately, Perandal our current chief took the matter very seriously. We do not know why and he decided to have the three young men judged. We all know they will be crucified. Welcome to the Lunar Peace!"

Jaridan: "your chief.. Perandal that is, and the Duke of AldaChur seem to show extraordinary zeal and in what way do you think we could help you? I am only a merchant after all."

The man: "you could accompany the escort and if our young men could live or at least die fighting, you would then in our eyes be the arm of divine justice."

Peek: "And why don't you do it yourself? I mean, free the young men."

The man: "We have attempted this kind of feat in the past but to save three we would make nine other victims. Such is Harvar's tribute. If you go see Perandal you will see that the Lunars are there to watch everything that happens here. Whereas if the young men were freed by strangers, the blame would not fall on the clan."

Jaridan to Peek: "What do you think?" Then to the man: "Give us a few moments please."

Peek: "That seems perilous. Do you think we could hide in AldaChur if things go wrong?"

Jaridan: “The city is big enough for us to be discreet. There are quite a few Sable nomads in the garrison around the city so your presence will not be too noticeable. And of course, we must use false names from now on: what do you think of Taros for me?”

Peek smiles: “Nice to meet you Taros, I am Rouk then.”

Jaridan continues: “Let us finish the meal and go present ourselves at Perandal’s hall.”

Jaridan signals to the man who returns and informs him they accept to try the feat. The man has a radiant smile and wants to offer them another round but Jaridan stops him: “We must now go see Perandal. I have a plan in mind.”

The fort of Glasswall (Hanya, Jaridan)

Jaridan’s objective is to meet Perandal and find a way to join the escort of the three prisoners heading to AldaChur.

Setback!

Peek and Jaridan leave the White Tree Inn intending to enter the main compound of the fort to go to the clan chief’s hall and speak with him but at the moment they get outside, a Lunar squad stops them and a Lunar officer accosts them: “you, the nomad, what are you doing here? and why are you not in your regiment?”

Peek is dumbfounded and can’t help but stifle a laugh.

Jaridan explains: “she is my guide and does not belong to any regiment.”

The stern-looking officer replies: “that is convenient to cover for a deserter. I remember her, she passed through here a few months ago with a group of nomads who were supposed to reinforce the forces in Tarsh to fight the Exiles and now she is suddenly alone.”

□ Convince the Lunar - Conflict: - honeyed tongue, convince - small chief, nomad desertions - Result 2 vs 2: setback

The discussion is heated and difficult with the officer. The heroes learn that there are many desertions among the nomads and that apparently the Lunars do not find their Praxian allies so reliable, which explains the officer’s zeal. Finally, Jaridan yields and declares that Peek will stay with them and in any case, they are going to AldaChur tomorrow and that is what he wants to talk to Perandal about. Jaridan places his arm on Peek’s shoulder to signal that everything will be fine.

The officer then leads Peek into the building right next to the inn which serves simultaneously as Lunar barracks, passage control center, and temple of the Seven Mothers and locks her in the same cell as the three young Orlanthis! Jaridan however has the right to enter the compound and go see Perandal. The Lunar seems satisfied: he recovered one of his own and what the Tarshite does is not his concern.

The meeting with Perandal (Jaridan)

Jaridan enters the fort compound. It is night and he heads toward the largest building. He passes a black glass post over 10 meters high standing in the center of the circular fort and has no trouble finding the building where the clan chief and his entourage are. He explains the reason for his visit to men outside who let him enter. The night is quite advanced now due to the setback with the officer and he hopes Perandal will receive him.

Perandal is not in bed and agrees to speak with Jaridan but seems in a hurry: "What do you have for me merchant? Or don't tell me you came to bother me to sell me something?" he says in an unfriendly tone.

The man seems martial, of a certain age, and wears his armor and weapon, as if he expects to have to fight at any moment, no doubt due to the proximity of Chaos in the region, Jaridan deduces.

But caught off guard, Jaridan tries to regain his composure. He has just realized that you do not visit a tribal chief without a gift. He decides to weigh his words and warn Perandal about their encounter with the ogres and that if he tells him about it it is because tomorrow he must leave for AldaChur but a man like him, renowned for his fight against Evil, must be informed that there was an ogre man and woman in the region and knowing the perfidy of these creatures, he had to be warned as soon as possible before they committed their misdeeds.

This makes Perandal laugh who declares that no ogre would ever dare come here! But he thanks Jaridan and prepares to end the audience when Jaridan tries to press his advantage by asking if he could accompany the Lunar escort that leaves tomorrow for AldaChur. He would feel safer.

□ Convince Perandal - Conflict: - art of discourse, being safe - does not want Heortians to know too much about this traitor delivery business - Result 2 vs 1: victory +1

Perandal seems to hesitate but tells himself that Jaridan is a Tarshite above all and therefore a foreigner, so he will not snoop in tribal affairs. He even thinks Jaridan is a bit simple-minded (because of the ogre story) and no doubt blinded by money given his expression when he mentioned gifts. He thus agrees and asks one of his men to accompany him to see Gomax to inform him that the merchant will join them tomorrow and benefit from their escort. Then he dismisses Jaridan who is effusive in thanks.

In the cells of Glasswall (Peek)

Peek enters the cell and seeing three young men chained with sad gazes, she understands she is with the three rebels they must free. She smiles inwardly. The men look at her and the light in their eyes revives. Once the jailer has left, Peek introduces herself and explains why she is there. She only hopes Jaridan will be able to accompany them because otherwise the escape will be all the more difficult and time will work against them because AldaChur is only a day or two's march depending on their pace. She regrets so much having lost her Kill the Stranger spirit that would have allowed her to eliminate this stubborn officer. But from what she understood, she is not really a prisoner but the Lunars just want to ensure she does not slip away in the night. She will thus recover her weapons and Fta-Ah tomorrow under Lunar escort who probably intend to take her to a Sable nomad camp for her to stay there. She thus intends to use the night to better know the

young men, their strengths, their weaknesses, the exact reason for their imprisonment and that they be ready at the time of their escape.

□ Succeed in obtaining interesting information - Conflict: - give them hope - they are afraid to talk, distrust of a Sable nomad - Result 1 vs 2: defeat -2

While one of the young men seems about to speak, suddenly another stops him. “Do you not see that this is a trick by Gomax or Perandal to worm information out of us? Be quiet. She is a Sable, she must be with them.”



Figure 29. Dungeon

The young man falls silent immediately and Peek will not learn more during this night, realizing that the escape risks being quite complicated if the three young men do not trust her and even believe she is in the enemy camp and obviously impossible to learn more about their abilities which could be useful to facilitate the operation. The three young men being chained, she finds a corner away from them to sleep with one eye open.

Hunting the Belli (Ikarnos & Hanya)

Continuation of Ikarnos & Hanya's adventures

Fugitives

Day has fully risen and Yelm now shines in the sky. Hanya and Ikarnos are pressed for time. The clan will realize Ikarnos's escape and will set out searching for him. The Dwarves are no longer a priori a threat as they must be too busy healing or mourning their old Dwarf. Do Dwarves mourn? They decide to head north as quickly as possible in forced march, tiring themselves out as long as they have not found a reasonably safe shelter.

They walked for half a day without stopping and are now exhausted as they approach a farm. Ikarnos recovered his dagger, his writings, his grimoire, and his medallion but still has only a shepherd's blanket as clothing. Ikarnos proposes to Hanya to pass him off as an amnesiac madman she encountered on the road and this might perhaps awaken compassion during their encounters. They are now theoretically far enough from the clan and must have entered the lands of another clan. They must not linger but they need to rest and feed. They decide to go to the farm after observing its activity for a few moments and not having perceived particular signs of warriors or unusual agitation.

Ikarnos thus enters the role of amnesiac man and Hanya marches proudly toward the farm.

"Hello, is anyone there?" she says in a confident voice.

A woman replies: "Who goes there?" and a large woman exits the house flanked by two alynxes followed by two sturdy fellows who resemble her a bit (probably her sons) and look like farm boys.

Seeing the warrior with her gleaming armor and double-bladed axe, the boys seize lances. "Peace friend, I am a traveler and I found this man wandering. He has trouble speaking and seems to have forgotten even his name. Do you recognize this man?" she asks to lend credibility to their ruse.

The large woman replies: "No, never seen.. you can go on your way."

□ Convince the woman - Conflict: - Sense the other's weakness, Bless the family - Hostile to strangers - Result 2 vs 1: setback

Hanya tries to play on the heartstrings, speaking of the large woman's sons, telling her they are two fine strapping lads for field work, and seeing the state of the fields tells her she could even give them a hand because she knows about construction, being a guardian of Jillaro one of the world's splendors, but the woman could not care less and replies rather curtly: "keep your spit, beauty, and go on your way, we do not know this man."

Ikarnos then decides to feign a sudden illness and simulate a fainting spell.

Hanya understands and says: "quick, we need to see what he has!"

The woman stops her: "wait beauty, he may have one of those diseases and out of the question that he gives it to us. We already have enough problems."

Hanya tries again differently by offering money, to stay in a barn and remain far from them and that perhaps if the woman told her of her problems, she could perhaps help them.

□ New attempt to convince the woman - Conflict: - money, barn, help -

distrust, fear of disease, stubborn character - Result 3 vs 3: defeat -3

The woman seizes a lance and with a swift motion slashes Ikarnos's arm who lets out a howl and comes out of his simulated faint. "There now he is on his feet. Leave before things turn ugly."

The woman seems totally obtuse and half mad. It thus seems our heroes will get nothing out of this and they must leave still exhausted to continue their flight.

The slavers

Ikarnos did not shed blood in the clan so apart from recovering his medallion, there is no reason to alarm the clan's men. Perhaps they even found the affair comical for the man who hoped to forge a reputation as a tough guy. As the saying goes, ill-gotten gains never prosper. Hanya tends a bit to Ikarnos's arm wound. For a week he will be handicapped in using his arm but the wound is not ugly.

Ikarnos reassures her with a smile: "In any case, I am a poor fighter."

They decide to continue north. According to Ikarnos, they have two or four days of walking before rejoining the main road from Tarsh to AldaChur. There should normally be a few inns along the road where they can eat. In the meantime, wilderness awaits them. They now try to pass by all dwellings and if they run into anyone, they will retry the story of the mad and wounded man found wandering in nature.

While our two heroes eat as best they can, swallowing a meager meal of fruits and a rabbit killed by Hanya, they hear a murmur behind them: "mmm mmm hello lovebirds, are you lost?"

A man in a tunic wearing sandals and a gladius along his right leg (probably left-handed) sizes them up with a smile. "My name is Hazz and I saw the smoke from afar, may I join you?"

Hanya nods in agreement and the man settles in. She introduces herself and the man points his chin at Ikarnos: "And him, he doesn't speak?"

Hanya hesitates but replies: "I found this poor wretch wandering in the hills, wounded.. He speaks little and seems to have even forgotten his name."

The man smiles: "that is very sad. Are you Lunar?" he says abruptly.

Hanya replies: "Yes I come from Jillaro and I must go to AldaChur, is the road still far?"

Hazz replies: "No you will be there tomorrow if you continue north. What will you do with the man?"

Hanya replies: "I do not know, I think I will find a Deezola dispensary that could perhaps help him."

The man shrugs: "That is noble of you" but adds in a low voice so Ikarnos cannot hear: "We could share his belongings and sell him, what do you think?"

Hanya is shocked but restrains herself: "Out of the question."

The man seems bothered.

Hanya questions him about his motivations and he replies: “the lands are hard here. The barbarians are hot-tempered and quarrelsome, Chaos threatens to the north and for Lunar colonists like me it is not really the promised land. I won a small estate during the games of Glamour and I did not think it would be so hard. But it is your choice, you prefer to favor a stranger over a Lunar citizen.”

The conversation continues and the man leaves, thanking her, but Hanya and Ikarnos do not feel right about it. They also leave and after an hour of walking, they fall into an ambush led by Hazz accompanied this time by four henchmen carrying lances.

“Hello Hanya, I reiterate my proposition. Leave us the man and share his belongings and we will be even. What do you think?”

Hanya has placed her hand on her axe and reflects but replies calmly: “Let me convince you that you would make a terrible error attacking us!”

□ Try to avoid conflict with Hazz and his men - Conflict: - Fazzur’s seal, mask of terror, Lunar citizen - greed, confident in their numerical superiority - Result 3 vs 2: victory +1

Hanya looks at Ikarnos who straightens up and drops his role. He no longer has any appearance of the poor wretch he was playing seconds ago.

He runs his hand through his hair and produces Fazzur’s seal: “I Ikarnos of Raibanth am here on these lands by order of general Fazzur. I have here as proof his seal. What you are about to commit will cost you dearly when the news reaches Bagnot and believe me, it will reach it Hazz!” he says, emphasizing the Lunar’s name to frighten him.

He hopes his bluff will pass because deep down he knows his disappearance will not move the great General. In war, a loss is a loss and a soldier is above all a sacrificial resource. For her part, Hanya radiates the Goddess’s Mask of Terror.

The men confer in low voices. Perhaps they tell themselves the price will be higher now that they know their true identity but Hazz seems hypnotized by Hanya’s terrifying face.

He stammers: “I do not know if your story is true or not, but as I told you, life is hard here. Leave quickly then and may the Goddess be with you. We are even and free. You were lucky to run into us because I, Hazz, know how to act honorably.

A Lunar citizen should not be sold and you should have told me that sooner.” He signals to his men and the small party begins to retreat toward the woods, remaining on their guard against Hanya’s threatening face who still firmly grips her double axe.

 **Plot twist!**

Arrested!

While our heroes think they are in the clear, they hear a voice behind them: “Do not move Lunars and drop your weapons!”

They turn around and see twelve Sartarites armed with lances, some with swords (armed thanes).

Ikarnos: “And what is happening here? Is it a custom to attack honest travelers?”

The man smiles, his sword in hand with which he seems to have a special relationship given the way it vibrates in his hand: “We have found what we were looking for. Come, disarm these dirty slave traders and tie them up. We return to the tula.”

Ikarnos and Hanya understand they may be taking them for Hazz’s accomplices.

Hanya: “ho ho ho, you are mistaken, we have nothing to do with Hazz the greedy, he even tried to sell us! Ask him! Let us chase him, he will tell you himself.”

Another man replies: “Silence viper, you are ready to do anything to save your skin and killing your slave supplier would not clear you.”

The men surround them. They are too numerous and too armed to attempt anything too risky. If only Jaridan were still with them.

Ikarnos replies: “you are mistaken and I place my destiny in the wisdom of your gods. If necessary, we will prove our good faith and if you provide us with men we will track down your real culprit who is none other than the man who calls himself Hazz.”

Then he sees other Sartarites emerge from the woods dragging Hazz wounded and battered along with two of his men. The other two missing may have managed to escape or their corpses now lie in the woods. The warrior with the sword: “do not worry, your accomplice is here and all the truth will be made about your sinister dealings that have gone on too long now. The wind rises and Lankhor Mhy sees all. Come, take them.”



Figure 30. Arrested

We leave the heroes tied and disarmed, dragged by the Sartarite party through the heath to reach the clan's domain.

Towards AldaChur (Jaridan & Peek)

Continuation of Jaridan & Peek's adventures

The escape

Dawn has not even risen when they take Peek and the three young rebels out of the dungeon.

Gomax the Lunar officer takes Peek aside and tells her: “you are going to rejoin the ranks now. We have our eye on you and soon you will join the Sables regiment of AldaChur. Your companion will find another guide once there. We will escort him to the city. No false steps if you want to live.”

Hanya thus finds Fta-Ah then Jaridan. Fortunately they do not prevent her from speaking to him and the men are more occupied preparing the prisoner escort.

Thus Peek can discreetly tell Jaridan what she experienced and saw in the cell with the young condemned: “they are afraid, they are terrified. I do not know if they are more afraid of their own people or the Lunars or both. They did not even believe me when I told them I came to help them. It will be difficult to get them out of there and at the same time, it must be done because out of the question that I, a khan's daughter, be treated like a common soldier in their army!”

Jaridan: "I understand you but calm down. But if we do not manage to free them, you can always escape from the camp."

How to free the three rebels? The situation seems complicated for our heroes. Surrounded by Lunar soldiers, with little room to maneuver and pressed for time since the journey will be very short. Perhaps a violent approach is finally the only option even if it implies heavy sacrifices.

The small party leaves Glasswall as Yelm appears on the horizon. Jaridan notices one of the prisoners looking desperately toward the fort walls, face closed and tense but nothing shows. After an hour of travel the fort has disappeared and they advance at a walk on the road leading to AldaChur. At the head of the procession, four Lunars on foot, then Gomax on horseback, then 3 other Lunars flanking the prisoners. Behind Jaridan on horseback and Peek on her antelope. In the rear, two Lunars on horseback. Jaridan discreetly prepares three daggers from his stock of goods he always carries with him. Our two heroes wait only for the right moment to act.

The morning passes without incident and after lunch, the group resumes.

Jaridan and Peek are still on the lookout for any sign. The Lunars are on alert because the proximity of the Serpent Pipe Hollow can always be a source of chaotic danger.

During the crossing of a bridge, the Lunars ignore the local rites while Jaridan pours a flask of water into the river to mark his devotion, surprised that the Lunars do not do the same.

Questioning Gomax on this subject, he declares they are not there to bother with these rites from another age and that the future is now in the worship of Yelm and the Goddess, which our heroes could verify because at noon, the group stopped and Gomax raised his palms to the sky to address a few words to Yelm.

While Jaridan discusses with Gomax, around a bend, the group freezes before a monstrous spectacle. A creature with a human head, lion's body and mane, and a scorpion's tail is devouring a giant boar! The group stops and Gomax organizes his tactics. Meanwhile Jaridan moves back to approach the rear and thus the prisoners. The Lunars are occupied with other things. It is time to act.



Figure 31. Manticore

□ Succeed in freeing the prisoners - Conflict: - take advantage of the diversion with the Manticore, cut the bonds, pass daggers to the prisoners - Lunar vigilance, prisoner distrust - Result 3 vs 2: defeat -2!

Jaridan takes time to decide to act. Indeed, the two mounted Lunars are not yet mounted at the front because Gomax has just created a defense line facing the Manticore. He watches the monster who also watches them with a cruel look.

But action must be taken, so he tries to cut the bonds of one prisoner but the latter takes fright seeing him approach with his dagger and declares: “What are you doing? Perandal ordered you to kill me, is that it? The dishonor is too great??”

This alerts the guards in the rear and one of the guards intervenes promptly, wounding Jaridan with his long lance! Jaridan lets out an oath.

□ Peek’s Intervention - Conflict: - death lance, combat with Fta-Ah, swift, stealth - numerical superiority, mounted, armed, armored - Result 4 vs 4: defeat -2!

Peek tries discreetly and thanks to Fta-Ah’s speed and agility to kill the two guards or at least one but she fails because the Lunars react promptly and wound her too. Jaridan shouts at her to flee!

□ Flee while helping the rebels - Conflict: - Fta-Ah swift, Lunars occupied by the Manticore, the rebels understood - cut a prisoner's bond, pass them daggers, remount on horse, wounded - Result 3 vs 4: setback

Jaridan tries to cut the bonds of a prisoner who now trusts him and presents his hands for him to cut the bond but he must give up because the Lunars charge him again. They must flee without being able to help them! They abandon the three daggers he had prepared on the ground hoping the prisoners will seize their chance but now he has only one thing on his mind: remount his horse and flee as far as possible with Peek.

□ Succeed in fleeing - Conflict: - Fta-Ah swift, Lunars surprised by the commotion front and rear, Peek fires arrows - wounded, remount on horse - Result 3 vs 2: victory +1

Despite the pain, Jaridan manages to mount his horse and thanks to Peek's arrows that destabilize the Lunars he manages to leave the combat zone. On the other hand, the prisoners rushed on the daggers which by luck created a diversion allowing Jaridan and Peek to escape into the woods at the edge of the road.

In the woods

Jaridan and Peek gallop at full speed through the woods to put as much distance as possible between them and the Lunars. They finally stop at a clearing. Out of breath, both wounded.

Peek: "it's good, I think they did not follow us in fact."

Jaridan: "too busy with the prisoners and the manticore.. what a horror that beast!"

Peek: "I hope she ended up attacking and made short work of it."

Jaridan: "the Lunars are numerous and I think the beast died rather.. as did the young rebels.. may Orlanth welcome them bravely in the Kingdom of Storms. At least they died as heroes."

Peek: "they finally understood we were coming to their aid."

Jaridan: "yes, they even seemed to believe their king personally held a grudge against them. I think the inn man was right, the king did not act by chance in condemning these three young men."

Peek: "we will never know. We must move on. I can't wait to reach Prax."

Jaridan: "Should we not honor our oath and wait for Ikarnos and Hanya at AldaChur?"

Peek: "we would then have to hide. Do you think that is possible there?"

Jaridan: "I no longer know. Your antelope will betray us and from what I understood, they will not let you wander freely outside the Sables regiment. As for me, I think I can easily hide in the market."

Peek: "I have an idea, let us go to Bullion-of-Moon and ask a messenger to watch for our

companions' arrival and deliver them the new meeting place. Let us bypass AldaChur and resume the road to travel more safely. We are wounded and we will find an inn to rest."

Jaridan: "your plan is judicious."

Then the two heroes tend to their wounds as best they can so they do not worsen. The pain will remain for a good week unfortunately unless they find a healer. Around them, the woods are calm. They resume the road at a walk, watching for every suspicious noise.



They have been advancing for a few hours, slowly through the increasingly thick forest foliage when suddenly, a whirling form brushes past them followed by a small feline with pointed ears. Jaridan recognizes an alynx, a sort of large cat domesticated by the Orlanthis since always, since Yinkin, the God of Alynxes accompanies Orlanth in his adventures.

The alynx leaps and pounces on its prey. Our heroes then discover between its large paws a small being of a few centimeters with insect wings. It seems terrified but a fierce determination shows on its strange angular face. Its small voice murmurs unintelligible words. Is this an appeal, a spell or some curse against its predator.

Peek knows nothing about alynxes and spins her bow over her shoulder. It ends up in the hand of an expert archer and she nocks an arrow. Jaridan hesitates: his Orlanthi culture forbids harming Alynxes. Peek looses her arrow which flies.

□ Wound the alynx - Conflict: - Bow, Alynx occupied - Swift - Result 3 vs 1: setback

The small creature lets out a terrible cry, shrill, at the limit of bearable. This unsettles Peek at the moment of shooting and the arrow sticks in a tree.

The alynx turns around, bares its fangs and begins to growl in their direction.

Jaridan, holding his hands over his ears, shouts to Peek: "perhaps we should not get involved? The alynx may not be alone."

Peek replies by nocking a second arrow and aiming at the animal: "then let it leave the creature alone!"

She threatens the alynx who looks at her with a gleam of intelligence. Perhaps it realizes that only its victim's cry saved it from Peek's arrow?

Jaridan understands Peek's intention and seizes his staff with a threatening air: "Go away!"

□ Succeed in driving away the alynx - Conflict: - shout in a clear voice, threaten it, appeal to its intelligence - holds its prey, swift, wild - Result 3 vs

3: victory +2

The alynx seems to hesitate and plays a few more moments with the small being but finally, it leaps without momentum to perch on a branch of a nearby tree and a few moments later, it disappears into the forest foliage.

Jaridan and Peek then approach the creature who rises with difficulty and flaps its small bruised wings. It looks at them frightened apparently and stumbles while backing away but stands up then its wings begin to vibrate in the air and the small creature takes flight. It pronounces a few incomprehensible words. Peek tries to make contact.

□ Succeed in making contact with the marcotte - Conflict: - spirit beast superior to man - fear - Result 1 vs 1: setback

The creature seems to hesitate while Peek has released the spirit beast superior to man and now seems to radiate an aura in harmony with the surrounding woods, but the small creature is perhaps too cautious or too weakened to risk contact with such giants and finally it flies higher and higher and with a sudden acceleration, it dashes deep into the forest disappearing from the sight of our two heroes.

The Trial (Ikarnos & Hanya)

Continuation of Ikarnos & Hanya's adventures

Accused by the Cherusii

Ikarnos and Hanya follow the Sartarites without resistance and eventually arrive at a fortified village. They learn the clan is called the Cherusii clan. The inhabitants watch them pass and the warrior leads them to the chief's hall. They are pushed to their knees before a thin man who looks at them with curiosity.

The warrior speaks: "You, Farindar, never wanted to shed light on the mysterious disappearances in our clan and never believed in the guilt of that traitor Hazz whom we nonetheless welcomed years ago. Yet I bring you proof of his guilt and here are his instigators! I saw them plot their crime. I demand that the Justice of Orlanth be rendered and that the truth of Humakt be pronounced for this scum!"

The chief strokes his goatee and seems doubtful. "Hynir, Hynir, always quick to call Death on what I see. Hmm.. perhaps to make up for your latest feat."

The assembly bursts out laughing.

But the said Hynir glares at them darkly. "So Hazz, do you have an explanation to give us?"

Hazz steps forward, weakened and trembling: "these two are envoys of Fazzur, I was trying to be clever when Hynir came to murder my men repeating his nonsense!"

Hanya nearly reacts with rage but Ikarnos dissuades her by placing his hand on her shoulder.

- Try to clear themselves - Conflict: - find the path to the solution, offer help
- Hazz's lie, anti-Lunar prejudices - Result 2 vs 2: victory +1

Ikarnos addresses Farindar: "this man speaks the truth, we are under Fazzur's protection and perhaps in your eyes this represents a crime but you would be wrong. Fazzur asked us to consolidate the Lunar Pax and not to inflame it. We are heading to Pavis and were only passing through the Dragon Pass when this man tried to enslave us, an activity he boasted about to us and I thus think this is not his first offense. I do not know the said Hazz and have no sympathy for those who exploit the weak for in doing so they show only weakness themselves. Surely you fought against the Red Moon, but we respect you because we know your strength. Individuals like Hazz are a disgrace. If you do not believe me, question my spirit and you will know. I am not afraid. My death may go unavenged because Fazzur is far but I will die as I have lived, with dignity. If you decide to kill us, grant me just one favor: let my warrior behead this worm."

The king strokes his goatee and says: "how unfortunate all this. What do you think Urulvir?"

An old man rises and looks at the prisoners. He extends before him a staff adorned with a transparent stone, squints to look through the stone's prism and closes his eyes.

- Make truth prevail while hiding Hanya's chaos contamination - Conflict: - make them forget names (to divert attention), they speak the truth - Hanya's contamination - Result 2 vs 1: setback

Urulvir clears his throat and speaks: "They speak the truth but I cannot see the whole situation clearly. Hazz is guilty in any case. The others are innocent regarding the slaves but are not reliable for all that." He sits back down.

Farindar: "I see you are wounded Lunar, you will be able to heal and will be our guest while we clarify your intentions a bit better. Hynir find them lodging. As for you Hazz I sentence you to become a slave. You will be taken to the slave market of AldaChur."

Ikarnos: "if I may, if Hazz is a Lunar citizen, he may escape your judgment, noble chief. Let the warrior end his pathetic life."

Farindar: "you seem quite eager to eliminate Hazz's life. I find that strange even though the wise Urulvir does not think you accomplices. Wind Day will bring me counsel and I will know what to do."

The trial is thus adjourned. Ikarnos and Hanya are led to the Armed Thanes' building. The lodging is spartate but correct. Hazz's cries of protest can be heard, probably being taken to a separate room to keep him prisoner with his two henchmen.

The trial

- Having lost the notes on the conflicts, only the narrative remains.

Ikarnos and Hanya are led to the guest house. They are not mistreated but four men bearing shield and lance stand guard outside the hut.

Ikarnos sits on a bench and stretches his legs: “here is another unfortunate setback but I do not think they will execute us. The fact that Hazz, a Lunar, lived among the clan means that they have somewhere accepted the Goddess’s victory.”

Hanya replies bitterly “they are quarrelsome barbarians, capable of changing their minds like the wind, like their master Orlanth.”

Ikarnos: “that is why we must make sure to represent something interesting. We could help them find the real instigators of this trafficking even if it will unfortunately take us even further from AldaChur.”

Hanya darkens: “I think for my part that this is not our business. Let us rather try to take the opportunity to heal your wound.”

Forced to brood, at nightfall, a meal is brought to them. Ikarnos tells Hanya they can eat without fear because it is not in the traditions to assassinate a guest. Time passes. They know the torque is gathered with the thanes in the clan dwelling.

After a while, the guards ask them to follow. It seems Chief Farindar has finally decided something. The clan dwelling is packed. A feast has taken place. Hazz and his two men are in chains. Ikarnos and Hanya are brought before the chief.

The latter stands and everyone falls silent: “I, Farindar son of Kilin, chief of the Cherusii, will render justice.”

A obese man adorned with feathers on his head and clothes bursts out laughing: “Justiiiiiiice!!” then begins to imitate pig grunts.

“Enough pig!” declares the chief. The jester falls silent, emitting a small meow. People laugh.

“When my father fought the Lunars, we were defeated. Few still remember it but it was not the Lunars who defeated us but the perfidious Lamars who betrayed us that day. We learned the lesson and have always respected the Empire’s rules without betraying our own.”

His gaze falls on the fierce warrior who arrested Ikarnos and Hanya. He resumes: “Our laws forbid death except by duel. We should therefore banish Hazz.”

A murmur of disapproval runs through the hall.

A woman screams: “This will not avenge our husbands and children taken from us!”

Farindar strokes his goatee: “we should but we will not!”

Men strike their shields with their lances: “Yeah! Well said!”

The chief continues: “we cannot kill him, we cannot exile him.. so what to do?” He shrugs. He signals to his wife who rises. She carries a smoking gourd.

Then he addresses Hanya and Ikarnos: “you proposed that your warrior rid us of the scoundrel. We do not want to be rid of him. We want to remember.”

Men approach Hazz and hold him with legs extended. The chief declares: “Take your axe and cut

off his legs!”

Hazz begins to scream: “Nooooooooon.. you have no right, I am an Empire citizen!!! You will be annihilated by my allies!!”

He drools. Hanya looks at Ikarnos. The latter closes his eyes a moment and reopens them: “blood calls for blood Farindar. Do you not want me to investigate the friends of this scoundrel?”

Farindar: “one does not prevent the other. Justice must be rendered, I owe it to my people. I add that if your warrior refuses, I will take this as a sign of loyalty to this scum.”

Hanya: “then I have no choice.” She advances. Hazz stares at her, terror in his eyes. Hanya raises her axe and it falls on the unfortunate man’s legs: “tchak! tchak!”

The crowd averts their eyes from the horror: horror of the mask of terror Hanya invoked, horror of seeing the two legs cut above the knees, horror of hearing Hazz’s screams as he falls unconscious.



Figure 32. Hazz torture

Warriors are admiring of the precision of the warrior’s cleaving blow. The chief’s wife kneels and takes from the gourd a smoking mud to apply on the stumps of the legless man.

Hazz still breathes. Farindar speaks, addressing Hazz’s henchmen: “you and you, I banish you for participating in this infamy. I authorize anyone to kill you if you approach the clan’s lands.”

Men release them and push them toward the exit. People throw garbage at them. The unfortunate man’s legs are thrown into the fire. “Hazz will remain in the clan and live like a pig eating our scraps. Let this remind each of us what happens when one tries to betray the clan.”

Ikarnos takes the opportunity to declare: “may I tell you something in private?”

Farindar: “approach.”

Ikarnos whispers in his ear: “let me follow the two men, I am sure they will rejoin their accomplices. If I were them, that is what I would do.”

Farindar looks at him. “So be it, Lunar, but your warrior stays with us until you return.”

Ikarnos understands the chief’s distrust and sees himself forced to accept. Time is running out. It has been a few minutes since Hazz’s two men left the hall and every instant counts. “This will not make my task easier but I accept despite my wound.”

He quickly goes to Hanya and tells her discreetly: “I will track down the two men and return as soon as I know more.”

Hanya casts a dark look at Jarindar but complies with Ikarnos’s orders who leaves the hall.

Ikarnos finds the men’s tracks in the mud. Wide strides, signs of fleeing. They head toward the village exit. Ikarnos thus passes the gate and finds himself at the fields. Exiles would not have risked treading the fields property of their Earth goddess Ernalda. He thus stays on the path and arrives in the wild lands around the clan and continues his pursuit.

Meeting with the Aldryami

Continuation of Jaridan & Peek’s adventures

The deep forest

□ Having lost the notes on the conflicts, only the narrative remains.

Jaridan and Peek advance through the forest at random, trying to orient themselves by the glimmers filtering through the increasingly thick foliage. But Yelm is sinking lower and lower, ready to return once more to the world of Darkness in accordance with the cosmic law of the Great Compromise.

Wounded, tired, they walk in silence, leading their mounts by the bridle. The surrounding sounds do not reassure them. They seem surrounded by an intense life they do not see, except from time to time: a squirrel slipping through, a bush rustling, leaves moving, a bird singing, an insect chirping.

They finally take a break. Sitting on a mossy rock,

Peek looks around her: “What a strange and oppressive place!”

Jaridan replies, biting into a piece of dried meat: “It certainly does not much resemble the great plains of Prax from what I have heard.”

Peek sharpens her arrows: “Have you ever been to a forest? What dangers await us?”

Jaridan: “We sometimes go into the woods but never very far. We cut down trees to build our houses or to heat ourselves in winter. Only the mad or the outcasts venture beyond. It is the

kingdom of Aldrya the great Goddess of Elves.”

Peek: “Elves? They really exist then? And you have seen some?”

Jaridan: “Never.. but the small creature we rescued resembled them. They say they are both man and plant. They say they hate men because men destroy their forests.”

Peek: “they also say a lot of things about us Nomads.. I only believe what I see or what the great spirits whisper to me.”

Jaridan: “Shhhh!”.

Peek and Jaridan seize their weapons because they heard a noise around them, then suddenly the foliage parts around them and they see advancing in a circle at a distance of about twenty paces, humanoids armed with pikes and bows, with bark armor, shields shaped like long leaves.

They are slender, their skin resembles wood, their eyes have no pupil but resemble brown fruits, some have moss instead of hair, others leaves. There are about twenty of them and they advance slowly, inexorably. Peek and Jaridan stand back to back, ready to defend their lives dearly. The Elves, for it is indeed a group of Elves, stop ten paces from Peek and Jaridan.

One of their number steps forward and begins to speak. The phrasing is strange, melodious and slow, like a chant. “Oooou aaanimaaaal baaaaad ooooooears leaaaaf?”

Fta-Ah begins to grow agitated and Peek tries to calm her. Jaridan tries to understand what the strange creature seems to be asking them.

Jaridan replies: “Me not understand, me not danger!” placing his hand on his heart.

The Elves seem to misunderstand his gestures or words and some draw their bows. Fta-Ah grows more and more agitated. Peek tries to calm her. The Elves see the nomad begin a calming chant to the antelope.

The latter lies down on her front legs, calmed. A few Elves unstring their bows, perhaps themselves calmed by Peek’s song.

Peek then takes advantage of this to declare: “We, lost, we, wounded, we, friends.” And she kneels, placing her weapons on the ground and inviting Jaridan to do the same as a sign of humility.

Time seems frozen. Suddenly a slight rustling is heard and the small creature that Peek and Jaridan saved from the alynx’s claws emerges from the forest. It heads toward one of the warriors in the rear, perches on his arm and speaks to him in a crystalline language. The man then begins to speak in a language of such beauty that shivers run along Peek’s and Jaridan’s cheeks.

When he speaks, the forest itself seems to respond to his words and one has the impression that everything that is plant vibrates in unison. “Tree grow” says the Elf who seems to know a few Theyalan words.

Jaridan and Peek do not understand but his gesture commands them to stand. Elves approach and recover their weapons. They seem to touch them as if it were poison. Then with a tongue click and pointing a direction, the Elves invite them to move. Peek and Jaridan lead their mounts by the

bridle, surrounded by warriors behind, on the sides and in front, and begin to advance into the deep forest.

Peek declares: “you see Jaridan, I only believe what the great spirits whisper to me.”



Figure 33. Aldryami

Glossary

Argrath: name spoken by the Tarshite Exile (a savior, a rebel leader, a prophet?)

Brontos: Storm Bull of the Apple Clan

Cai Delli: ogre

Caius Brontex: magistrate at Bagnot (friend of Fazzur)

Cherusii: Sartarite clan (whose leader is Farindar)

Clousilex: name given by Isidilian as a dwarven contact at Pavis

Elemenoria: witch of the Falling Ruins

Farindar: leader of the Cherus clan

Fazzur the Learned: conqueror of Prax

Gartinor: a grey sage cited by Irken as practicing divination

Gazzams: sort of dinosaurs

Gomax: lunar officer posted at Glasswall

Goundar: dwarf of Dwarf Mine

Grindaroum: dwarf (very very old) of Dwarf Mine having a Vision Stone.

Harvar Iron Fist: duke of AldaChur allied to the Lunaries and converted to Yelmalio.

Hazz: lunar colonist who practices slave trading.

Hynir: Sartarite war thane

Imex Rapiis: tactical advisor to Pharandros (member of the Secret Phrases)

Irken: youth of the Apple Clan who lost his brother Riken killed by ogres.

Irmir: man of the Apple Clan

Isidilian: King of Dwarf Mine

Jaknar the Red: stole Dwarven weapons

Jakran: one of the warriors of the village at the foot of the cliff

Jarlan: leader of the Apple Clan

Jirudal: man of the Apple Clan

Jomes Wulf: man who fought the Telmoris (werewolves)

Kalia: woman of the Apple Clan

Korlan: the man of the Apple Clan who took the dwarven medallion

Lamars: enemy clan of the Cherusii (betrayed them during the lunar invasion)

Nigmar: one of the dwarven warriors of Dwarf Mine

Perandal: leader of the Princeros tribe based at Glasswall

Pizidan: man of the Apple Clan sitting on the Circle

Pommiers (Apple Clan): the apple clan. A Sartarite clan renowned for its consecrated apples.

Pharandros: young king of Tarsh and nephew of Fazzur

Sheena: healer priestess of the Apple Clan

Sigmar: leader of the village at the foot of the cliff

Urulvir: old Sartarite sage

Visa Delli: wife of Cai Delli (ogress)